Between *millo* and *picó*: music as discursive masking in *La Puntica No Ma'*, a costume troupe of the Barranquilla Carnival (Colombia)

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1. Introduction

Colombia's Caribbean coast is home to many of the country's most colorful and recognizable traditions. Barranquilla Carnival is perhaps the most prominent example. It is the largest festival in the country, received more than one million visitors in 2019 (Cotelco 2019), and perfectly reflects the highlights of the Colombian Caribbean culture and at the same time the socioeconomic differences that characterize the region, one of the most unequal in the country (UNDP 2021). Its music, costumes and dances have been a seal of identity for different population niches, but it is also the object of appropriation by others with more power in the social hierarchy. This has created a series of narratives and discourses that for many years were considered unique and true, and that have forged different ways of understanding this carnival.

Thanks to the processes of globalization, the Barranquilla Carnival is taking on new forms, as recent ideas have gained strength and have come into tension with all those social, political and economic dynamics of past decades that have been passed down from generation to generation. This paper attempts to explain how narratives and representations have been consolidated creating different discourses of the carnival, specifically on authenticity, and how today the tensions underlying their coexistence are perceived in the music listened to and enjoyed by the members of a collective costume troupe, called *La Puntica No Má'*, a *comparsa*[1] (actually, a collective costume troupe) of the Carnival of Barranquilla.

Reviewing White's definitions of narratives, representations and discourses (1990), the main ideas on authenticity (Salge Ferro 2014, 2018; Smith 2006, 2011, 2014; Kim, Oh, Lee & Lee 2018; Wesener 2017; Wang 1999; Yi, Lin, Jin & Luo 2017) and Appadurai´s Five „Scapes“ of Globalization (1998), an attempt is made to answer a simple question:

[1] *Comparsa*s are organized and coordinated ensembles that perform together, often with characteristic costumes, music or dances during carnival. A collective costume troupe is a type of *comparsa*, whose importance lies in the costumes and their elaboration. Some researchers have used the term to describe other types of *comparsa*s, such as Rey Sinning, who describes the Marimondas as "The most autochthonous and picturesque collective costume of Carnival" (1996 : 78), however, because these groups have a special emphasis on dance choreography, this would be better classified as a *dance comparsa*. On the other hand, it is possible to divide the collective costume *comparsas* into those that replicate the same costume for all their members, for example, the *comparsa* of *Los Burros Corcoveones* [The Corcoveones Donkeys] (Ortega 2022) and those that do not, such as *Disfrázate como Quieras* [Dress up as you want] (López 2023).

How can discourses be identified through the music listened to and enjoyed by the members of a carnival *comparsa*?

And above all:

What discourses on authenticity about the Carnival of Barranquilla can currently be recognized in the music listened to and enjoyed by the members of the same collective costume troupe, such as *La Puntica no má*'?

After answering these questions, it was possible to identify two musical genres that had apparently contradictory discourses on authenticity, which were deciphered after dividing their positions into imaginaries. These discourses gave shape to the concept of *discursive masking* that served to understand how discourses act within the same system, which in this case is the comparsa of *La Puntica No Má'*.

The methodology adopted for the realization of this work included the participatory observation, so it was necessary for the researcher to make a field trip to the city of Barranquilla during the carnival season in the year 2023. The researcher participated in the different activities organized by *La Puntica no má'*, mainly parties, pedagogical and logistic activities and parades. Being part of this carnival collective group was essential to make notes, surveys, interviews and videos, which were processed in order to make the corresponding analysis for this work.

1.1. The Colombian Caribbean, Barranquilla and its Carnival

Talking about the Colombian Caribbean means understanding one of the most striking and diverse regions of the country. It is located in the north of the country, being the region that borders the Caribbean Sea. Meisel and Pérez (2006) speak of a great variety of ecosystems ranging from the deserts of *La Guajira* peninsula to the great savannas of Córdoba and Sucre, passing through paradisiacal beaches, many rivers such as Magdalena -navigable and considered the most important in the country-, and the perpetual snows of the *Sierra Nevada de Santa Marta.*

Understanding the people of this region of Colombia can also be very complex since it is a mixture of people of different origins such as Spaniards, local indigenous people, Africans who arrived during the colony as slaves, English, Italians, Germans, Jews, Arabs from countries such as Lebanon, Syria and Jordan, Chinese, among many others (Zambrano Pantoja 2006). The interaction of all these people located in different ecosystemic varieties forged in turn local identities that remain today, for example, the *Ribereños* -the coastal people who live on the banks of the Magdalena River-, the *Sabaneros* -those who live in the savannas of the western coast where cattle ranching is part of the landscape- and the *Guajiros* -who live on the Guajira Peninsula and have to deal with the great desert that characterizes

this sub-region (Acevedo Merlano 2020). Despite the great diversity of cultural elements that characterize this region, all its inhabitants are often referred to as *Costeños* (Acevedo Merlano 2020; Agudelo 2013) or *Caribbeans* for all those who identify with the Caribbean culture, regardless of whether they live in front of the sea or not, and which is associated with the way of being of the people who live in the Caribbean Basin and includes people from Spanish-speaking, English-speaking, French-speaking and Dutch-speaking countries (Acevedo Merlano 2020; Premdas 1996). The countries facing this sea are usually called Caribbean countries, although in some cases only a part of their inhabitants identify themselves as Caribbean, since only a part of their territory is economically, politically, historically and culturally linked to this region, for example, the Colombian Caribbeans, the Floridians in the United States and the yucatecans in Mexico. (See Appendix A).

All *Costeños* are seen by Colombians from other regions as cheerful and jocular people (Agudelo 2013; Gómez Pino & Villadiego Díaz 2016). This perception is also given by the *Costeños* themselves and their music to a large extent transmits this idea of happiness and celebration, which of course is taken advantage of by the people of Barranquilla to promote their cultural events (Hernández Salgar 2014). Barranquilla is a city of 1,115,490 inhabitants[2], capital of Departmento de Atlántico [Department of Atlántico], located also in the Colombian Caribbean (See Appendix B). Due to its strategic location on the banks of the Magdalena River and facing the Caribbean Sea, the city became a meeting point for different ethnic groups and migrants of different origins. For this reason, it has a vibrant mix of cultural, economic and social influences that makes the city stand out for its diversity and vitality (Sourdis Nájera 2017).

Understanding Barranquilla always implies stopping at its biggest festival, the Carnival of Barranquilla, which lasts four days and always ends one day before Ash Wednesday, a holy day for the Catholic faith. During the time the carnival lasts there are parades, street parties, private parties in clubs and commercial establishments, contests, and many concerts. In its parades it can be observed an endless number of dances, with costumes of all kinds and very lively music, which are a consequence of a great mixture of all the cultural influences that Barranquilla and the Colombian Caribbean region received during the last centuries. For all the above mentioned, the Carnival of Barranquilla was declared Intangible Heritage of Humanity by the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO) in 2008[3].

[2] According to the 2018 DANE census (Departamento Administrativo Nacional de Estadística - National Administrative Department of Statistics): www.dane.gov.co (accessed August 10, 2023).
[3] Barranquilla Carnival site on UNESCO's website: https://ich.unesco.org/es/RL/el-carnaval-de-barranquilla-00051 (accessed August 10, 2023).

1.2. Carnival music

However, all carnivals have elements in common, for example their origin in the Dionysian festivities, which came from Greece to Rome, spreading throughout the territory of the Roman Empire as the Saturnalian festivities (or simply as Saturnalia) until their introduction in the Middle Ages with the name they are known today. (Covo Torres 1990; Friedemann 1985). During the Renaissance it spread throughout the Christian world and then to other geographical contexts through conquests and exchanges with Europe (Vignolo 2006). The celebratory and unbridled character inherited through the ages, contrary to what the church dictated, also determines another of the core elements of the carnival: its music. This is usually joyful, energetic, jocular, provocative, boisterous and danceable music. Often, carnival songs and melodies focus on themes of celebration, fun, cultural identity and social satire.

Carnival music varies widely according to locality and specific cultural tradition. It can include a mixture of musical styles and genres, such as folk music, popular music, traditional music and dance music. Some well-known examples of carnival music include samba in the carnival of Rio de Janeiro (Brazil), *Basler Trommeln* music in Basel (Switzerland), calypso in the carnival of Trinidad and Tobago, marches and polkas in the carnivals of Cologne (Germany) and Venice (Italy), and *candombe* in the carnival of Montevideo (Uruguay). However, these carnivals do not always feature this music, which is considered more folkloric, but also other more commercial musical genres known to non-local audiences. Electronic music, for example, could not be absent in Notting Hill in London or Tenerife in Spain, but neither in Gualeguaychú in Argentina or Salvador in Brazil.

In Barranquilla, precisely, the musical genre with which its carnival is most associated is *cumbia* (F. Ochoa 2017). A rhythm that in turn has a characteristic dance and attire during carnival times. Musically it is a genre that has a binary time, moderate tempo and is generally not so syncopated as other Caribbean rhythms (See Appendix C). It is rather calm and lilting. In carnival times it is played with three types of drums -*alegre*, *llamador* and *tambora*- and a minor percussion instrument which can be a *maraca* or a *guache*, a cylindrical friction instrument. This instrumental format is called *conjunto de caña de millo*, *conjunto de pito de millo, conjunto de pito atravesao* or *grupo'e millo*, due to its melodic instrument of indigenous origin: the *millo* flute[4] (F. Ochoa 2019; See Appendix D). Carnival cumbia and the other music heard during this festival are in fact the result of multiple exchanges between the city, the region, the country and the Caribbean basin. Along with the *millo* group, there are other types of ensembles that participate in the carnival, these are:

[4] Also called *pito atravesao*, *pito de millo* or simply *millo*.

- The folkloric groups, which can be groups of *millos* or *gaitas*[5]. Sometimes the wind instrument is the clarinet and this is simply called "folkloric group". These formats interpret rhythms such as *cumbias*, *bullerengues*, or *mapalés*, musical genres considered folkloric. The *millo* group performs almost exclusively three genres which are *puya*, *porro* (also called *son corrido* or *jalaíto*) and *cumbia* (Ochoa 2019).
- *Papayeras* or bands of wind instruments (clarinets, trumpets, trombones, euphoniums, etc.) and percussion (snare drums, *bombos*, cymbals, etc.) that play musical genres such as *porros* and *fandangos*, very popular in the western Colombian Caribbean in the savannahs of the Departments of Córdoba and Sucre.
- The *parrandas vallenatas*, with percussion instruments such as *cajas vallenatas* and *guacharacas* (both percussion instruments), and accordions, with which they play the different *aires vallenatos* or *vallenato* airs (*paseo*, *son, merengue vallenato* and *puya*), very popular in the east of the Colombian Caribbean, especially in the Departments of Guajira, Cesar and Magdalena.
- Tropical orchestras, which maintain a format similar to that of Big Bands, composed of four or five instrument sections: wind section (brass such as trumpets, trombones and saxophones, and woodwind instruments such as flutes, and clarinets), rhythm section (piano, bass, guitars, drums and minor percussion), vocal section (choir and main vocalist) and an optional string section (violins, violas and cellos). They perform musical genres such as salsa, merengue, bachata and cumbia, adapted to this format.
- The *picós* refer to the sound systems that take on large dimensions during the carnival and perform electronic music genres or fusions, such as *champeta* and dance-hall. It should be noted that it is also called *picó* to any sound system that seeks to amplify any type of music, including international electronic or mainstream music.

All this music always sounds during the four days of carnival in every corner of the city. However, carnival music actually sounds long before those days. Before Christmas, Barranquilleros[6] can feel the carnival not only because the *comparsa*s (carnival groups or troups) that have been preparing and practicing their choreographies tirelessly in the streets, squares, parks and community halls of the city, but also because many artists take advantage of these moments of joy to launch their songs hoping that some of them will have a special importance in the next carnival. For this reason, many Christmas songs are confused in Barranquilla with carnival songs.

There is precisely one song that annually reminds Barranquilleros that the Christmas period is the starting point of carnival and it is *Las cuatro fiestas* [The Four Parties], composed by maestro Adolfo Echeverría in 1960 and popularized by the voice of Nury Borrás in a 1961 recording (Cuadros 2021; Maldonado Ortega 2018). This song speaks of the dates that, without exception, all those born in Barranquilla should celebrate: *El Día de las Velitas* [Day of the little Candles] (January 7/January 8), Christmas, New Year's Day and, finally, the carnival festivities (Rincón Vanegas 2020). In its own way, this song implies that music is a vehicle that traces a cyclical life path of what is truly important to the

[5] The *gaitas* are wind instruments of indigenous origin, made of wood, pitch and an embouchure made with the feather of a duck, although today they are also made of plastic. There are variations of this instrument: the female *gaita*, which plays the melody and has five holes, and the male *gaita*, which has two holes and accompanies the melody of its female counterpart.
[6] People of Barranquilla.

people of Barranquilla in relation to their city, with carnival being one of its crucial moments. This music is kept alive throughout the year and is renewed when Christmas approaches again, however much of this music remains as a heritage in the minds and the bodies of the Barranquilleros who continue to listen and dance to it even though many years have passed since its composition (Bassi & Solano 1999, 2017).

Carnival music has, in turn, many spaces for development and dissemination during these festivities. On the one hand, there are the physical spaces such as parades, *verbenas* and *k-zs* (*casetas)*[7], discos, clubs, street parties, concerts, in private homes and practically any commercial establishment, be it a shopping mall, a large supermarket or a grocery store (Bassi & Solano 1999, 2017; Rey Sinning 1992; Wade 2000). It is noteworthy that on the third day of carnival and since 1969, the concentration of the public attending this great event is focused on the Festival of Orchestras (Rey Sinning 1992). Individual artists and groups of different musical genres and nationalities compete from the afternoon of that day until the early morning of the following day to win the *Congo de Oro*, the highest award given by the organizers to the best exponents of regional music during the carnival. To give their verdict, the jurors take into account criteria such as tuning and musical coupling, orchestration and creativity, originality, technique and instrumental execution, vocal performance and interpretation, staging, stage management and audience acceptance (Carnaval de Barranquilla S.A.S).

On the other hand, there is the radio, which helped and still help to shape what it is understood today as carnival music from Barranquilla (Ochoa 2014; Wade 2000), and lately the digital media, including social networks (Salge Ferro 2020). Thanks to technological advances and new broadcasting channels, we see that artists and groups try to promote their musical projects not only on the radio, but in digital spaces like Youtube or Spotify. Their goal is always the same: to position their song as "The Carnival song", appropriate and strongly requested by the carnival public. This represents large sums of money, not only because of the royalties for reproduction that musicians accumulate through these new portals and applications thanks to the number of clicks made by fans of their songs, but for their possible participation in private or public concerts during the carnival, such as the Festival of Orchestras, which in turn means a factor of prestige.

2. Theory

[7] *Verbenas* are neighborhood parties or concerts that tend to be held during carnival. *K-zs* tend to be larger than *verbenas* and can occur at any time of the year (Sánchez 2022).

This section will explore the conceptualization of narratives, discourses and representations according to Hayden White (1990), offering relevant examples related to the Carnival of Barranquilla. Next, the narratives and representations of this carnival will be examined from the perspective of globalization, following Appadurai's (1996) approach. Finally, the various discourses on authenticity will be analyzed, as proposed by Salge Ferro (2020), also providing examples related to the Carnival of Barranquilla.

2.1. Narratives, discourses, and representations of the music of Barranquilla Carnival

In "The Content of the Form: Narrative, Discourse and Historical Representation" (1990), Hayden White developed the concepts of narrative, discourse and representation as fundamental tools for understanding how historical knowledge is constructed and communicated through historical writing, both in academia and in general culture. These concepts highlight the idea that there are no objective and neutral narratives, but that all forms of knowledge are cultural constructions, which in turn allow us to interpret and understand the world around us, help us to be critical and offer other different visions of reality.

White was a historian and theorist of history and that why the text explores representations in the field of history, but also expands it to other types of products such as visual ones, in particular it exposes photography as a type of representation. Consequently, and due to the broad nature of his ideas, the other two concepts addressed by him in the book (narratives and discourses) are applicable to the field of history as well as other humanities as they can all focus on the analysis and interpretation of the ways in which knowledge is constructed and communicated. In the same way these concepts can be transferred to the field of ethnomusicology since all three concepts can analyze and understand music and musical practices in specific cultural contexts, with actors who (i) create narratives through experiences, stories, beliefs, values, collective histories and meanings associated with music and its function in society; (ii) embody representations related to their preferences, including musical or extra-musical aspects such as dress, dance, scenography and iconography associated with music empathize, and (iii) ignore or reject discourses related, for example, to identity and power dynamics.

Because the book was published in the 1980s, subsequent generations of historians, theorists and scholars interested in the theory of history, the philosophy of history and cultural studies have been influenced, debating and discussing its impact on the academy to this day.

2.1.1. Carnival narratives

Narrative refers to the way stories are told or events are recounted. They follow a structure, that is, they have an introduction, a development and a conclusion. They are literary or rhetorical constructions, so they can be both fictional and non-fictional, and reflect the interpretations and

perspectives that an individual - who may be a historian or, in the present case, the different voices that make up a *comparsa* - selects and organizes in a coherent and meaningful way. In this way, narratives can be based on real facts, personal experiences, news published in the media, but also on myths, legends, local traditions or simply on the creativity and imagination of the narrator.

In this way it can be said that the narratives of the Carnival of Barranquilla include all the elements that are told about the carnival could include the history of the carnival, its origins, its evolution over time, the work to turn the event into a local, national and world heritage, and the stories of the different traditions and characters that participate in the event. The carnival has many narratives that have been accumulated and complemented thanks to the work of different actors such as historians, cultural managers, the media, carnival organizers, carnival makers (artists who create and participate in the parades and other activities of the event), the public, sponsors and academics. In this way they can be captured in journalistic notes, interviews, written memoirs, fiction books about the carnival, descriptions of the dances and costumes, legends and myths about the origin of the costumes.

A narrative about the music of the Barranquilla Carnival could be a chronicle about the adaptation in tropical orchestra format of a traditional Colombian *cumbia* played in a private club during the carnival in the 1940's. This narrative would follow a traditional narrative structure, presenting a chronological and coherent sequence of events with a beginning, a development and an end. The narrative could be told by one of the musicians of the group 20 years later and could focus on the difficulties the members had in choosing the song and adapting it, on the decisions they made about the instrumentation and arrangements, the experiences they had during the performance, and it is possible that many things did not happen as they did, but that is how he remembered it and that is how this narrative continued to be replicated for many years. Another possibility could be that this chronicle was told by a journalist from a local media the day after the presentation from his perspective as a member of the audience and could focus on his emotions during the concert, the reception of this proposal and the little publicity given to the event.

2.1.2. Carnival discourses

White considers discourses to be the systems of rules and conventions that shape the way in which historical narratives are produced and interpreted. Language, narrative structures, theories and ideologies construct discourses that serve to induce the way in which certain stories are told, but also esteem and promote the stories that are told and those that are ignored. White explains that they are cultural products that are subject to change and transformation over time.

Thus, Barranquilla Carnival discourses present specific approaches that shape the way Carnival events are told. These approaches are situated under a wide range of perspectives and opinions that could include social, political or economic issues, for example, on power, in its class or gender variants,

diversity, identity, creativity, heritage and its role in the local economy, arts education and its role in social cohesion, environment and waste management or innovation through technological advances and social networks. These discourses may come from political leaders, cultural figures, carnival participants, media and the general public, who may be influenced by a political, social or ideological context in which certain narratives were created, but also by the specific context in which the author of the discourse turns to such narratives and quotes them.

A discourse about the music of the Carnival of Barranquilla can be perceived by reviewing the way in which an actor in the discourse highlights certain elements over others, showing a clear position on them, for example in the case of the chronicle made by the member of the group in the format of a tropical orchestra, the musician can emphasize the group's specific interest in creating a proposal that in the future will become a musical hit that will transcend and become part of the carnival cultural heritage and in turn generate important economic gains for his guild, or his narration can focus on remembering that this music challenged class norms by performing music of popular origin that was not allowed in certain spaces of power such as a club of the Barranquilla elite. For his part, the journalist could have used the same discourse on power, but criticized the fact that the musicians who performed had to adjust to certain norms of the elites, since they preferred to stylize the music to the style and particular taste of the ruling classes, adapted their way of dressing and performed this work in a space that excluded most of the population that was not invited to the event, which is the reason for the low publicity of the event. Or perhaps he directed his discourse to the fact that the proposal intentionally embraced a diversity of musical influences, especially from the Caribbean basin, which are evident throughout the carnival celebration.

2.1.3. Carnival representations

For White, representations are the ways in which historical events are presented and interpreted. Thus, texts, paintings, photographs, films, and other forms of cultural expression can be representations. According to White, representations are not simply reflections of a past reality, but rather constructions mediated by the narratives and discourses that underlie them. For this reason representations are rather subjective and selective, and may convey certain meanings and interpretations while omitting others.

We can understand as representations of the Barranquilla Carnival all those artistic forms, such as music, dance, costumes, masks, makeup, floats and visual arts that are physically presented during the carnival. However, the selfies posted by the public during a carnival party, the photographic material published by tourist agencies, the facade and contents of the carnival museum supported by the government of Barranquilla and private institutions that support it, and the decoration of carnival spaces. In this sense, the representations can also come from political leaders, cultural figures, carnival

participants, the media and the public and are the reflection of a political, social, or ideological context in which certain manifestations were created, but also the reflection of a specific context of the author or authors of the representation.

In our example of the musical proposal of a group in the format of a tropical orchestra, we can say that the representation can be manifested in multiple ways. The musical intervention of the orchestra itself is a representation where a certain air of sophistication could be observed, feigned by the members of the band in order not to be out of tune with the environment and its audience. It could also be the photos taken by the journalist that perhaps emphasize not only the orchestra but the context in which it is located (private social club, elegant, aimed at local elites, without much racial or socioeconomic diversity). A final example could be a video of a current band performing a cover version of the same song emulating the style and manner in which it might have been performed in the last century or parodying it by showing the band members as people who are out of tune with their surroundings.

2.2. Narratives of Carnival from the perspective of globalization

The city of Barranquilla and its carnival have changed over the years due to various reasons that impact the social, political and economic order. In the same way, the stories of its participants (the narratives) have changed, and with it, the different discourses and representations. In other words, in order to identify the interests of the carnival actors through their discourses and the expression through their representations, it is worthwhile to understand the different narratives about the carnival that have been documented and that can be related to the different periods of the city of Barranquilla, with respect to its carnival. This turns out to be quite an arduous task due to the amount of existing information. For this purpose, it was necessary to resort to Arjun Appadurai's studies on globalization, particularly those associated with the dimensions of globalization (Appadurai 1996; See Appendix E). This made it possible to classify the narratives taking into account three historical periods.

To begin with, Barranquilla is not a city that originated during the colony, although it received much influence from it because it is part of a country that was colonized. It was proclaimed a village on April 7, 1813 by the governor of the Free State of Cartagena, Manuel Rodríguez Torices, before obtaining the title of city in 1857 (Alcaldía de Barranquilla 2020; Amaya 2023). It is important to know this, because the first narratives of Carnival are those that are circumscribed from the nineteenth century, when the city began to form, this being a first period. The second period we will take it from the 30's of the 20th century when the country began to interact with other countries due to new technological advances such as the radio and television. The last period begins with the new century in which we live and coincides with the declaration of the Carnival of Barranquilla as national and world heritage.

	I. FORMATION (19th c.- 1930)	II: INSTITUTIONALIZATION (30´ - 2000)	II INTEGRATION (2000-today)
ETHNOSCAPE	Barranquilla is a port. A youth city, that wasn´t founded during the colony but for **migrants** (foreigners and colombians). The Carnival of Barranquilla is a manifestation created by migrants, many of them from cities that already had carnivals and that today no longer exist.	**Internal desplacement** because of the violence and war.	**Mass tourism** after the peace treaty (2016) and the Declaration of the Carnival as a national heritage site (2001) and as a world heritage site (2003) ->Unesco **Virtual communities**
TECHNOSCAPE	Musical field: Instruments that comes with migrants.	Radio, recording studios. TV. Cinema.	**Internet, smartphones, streaming, apps, algorithm, cyberspace,**
IDEOSCAPE	Freedom. Sovereignty. Privilege maintenance.	Creation of a national sentiment. Expansion of capitalism. Good taste in carnaval music.	**Representation of minorities**. Walfare. Rights. Copyrights.
FINANCESCAPE	Creation of new industries for the construction of the country after independence. Colombian peso as a currency	Credit cards. International market entry. Free zones. Colombian **socioeconomic stratification system. Carnival is the most economically-relevant event for Barranquilla**	New transfer technologies (Paypal).
MEDIASCAPE	Newspapers	Radio. Television. films.	Internet, streaming, apps, **influencers**.

Table 1. Periods of the city of Barranquilla and the carnival, considering the dimensions of globalization, according to Appadurai (1996)

In this way we can establish the following narratives according to the periods in which they appeared. The period of appearance of a specific narrative does not mean that this narrative has ceased to be told at later times; on the contrary, in some cases the contents related to these narratives were expanded.

2.2.1. Carnival narratives, established from the formation period

This period is characterized as the starting point of Barranquilla as a new city that welcomed people from other parts of the country and other nations, specially from Europe, Middle East, and Asia. At this time the city welcomed elements, entrepreneurships, and traditions of people from other origins, including, for example, artifacts such as musical instruments and the creation of businesses. The foreign must have molded or merged with the local society as a result of the colonial era, whose population was composed of a mixture of Spaniards, Africans and indigenous people (Polifroni Lobo 2022). It is at this time that the Colombian peso was created as the country's currency (Albarracín Restrepo 2023). Communication was mainly through pamphlets and newspapers, and it was a time when values such as freedom and sovereignty flourished, typical of a young nation, but also others such as multiculturalism due to the reception of migrants.

2.2.1.1. Early narratives of the carnival: origin and first years of carnival in the city

The oldest historical accounts date from the second half of the 19th century (Buelvas 2006). They describe the first parades, the floats and the costumes of participants of the event, and present the figure of *Rey Momo* [King Momo], a fictitious character shared by many Latin American carnivals, who is generally a man who has contributed significantly to the construction of the Carnival and who is

designated as such for an edition of the Carnival, earning the admiration and respect of the Carnival's participants. These stories are mainly found in old newspapers.

It is important to say that from the second period (Formation) historians begin to inquire about what happened at this time and it is when the creation of the carnival is narrated in more detail going back to the eighteenth century when in Cartagena, a colonial city neighboring Barranquilla, the "Cabildos de Cartagena" were held. Over there the enslaved population of African origin and their descendants parodied the Hispanic hierarchical institutions and the abolition of privileges in celebrations that lasted all day until dawn and were annoying and frowned upon by the church and government authorities. They explain that the Carnival of Barranquilla was actually a celebration transferred from Cartagena. According to them the carnival shows how slaves took control and their role in a society that oppressed them. This narrative can be seen in books and academic articles written by González Henríquez (2006), Miranda Freitas (2013) and Abello Vives & Macías (2021). Other researchers of this period go even further back and review the origin of Carnival from ancient Greek and Roman times, through the Saturnalian festivities or simply “Saturnalia” (Covo Torres 1990; Friedemann 1985; Orozco Cantillo & Soto Mazenett 1997; Soto Mazenett 1999). The above are complemented by the ideas of the classical theory of carnival approached by Bakhtin (Bakhtin 1987; Lachmann 1988-89) who sees in carnival a temporal space in which hierarchies are inverted, since it breaks with all the structures, conventions and institutions of society, through rites and symbols that highlight corporeality, its material excesses, the grotesque (seen as the superimposition of opposing elements such as the serious and the comic, or the sacred and the profane), polyphony as opposed to a single dominant voice, and laughter, understood not only as entertainment, but as a form of liberation. They focus mainly on explaining how the party of today is related to the rites of the past.

2.2.2. Carnival narratives, established from the institutionalization period

This period begins with the arrival of the phonograph and radio in Colombia and the popularization of orchestras in *big band* format in Barranquilla (Hernández Salgar2014; Rey Sinning 1992). During the early years of this time Barranquilla experienced an economic boom as a result of an accelerated industrialization that was largely developed by the national and foreign migrants of the first period and that seduced people such as peasants and fishermen of the region in search of job opportunities. These then became the salaried workers of the local Barranquilla companies. A process of rapid urbanization was evidenced, but with an unequal development that resulted in the gentrification of the elites and the exclusion of the less favored (Rey Sinning 1996). The second part of the 20th century saw the beginning of the current Colombian armed conflict that brought with it the forced displacement of thousands of people from rural areas to large cities such as Barranquilla and also established the

current Colombian stratification system that shapes the daily lives of Colombians dividing society into six categories or *estratos*[8].

2.2.2.1. Narratives of carnival from the folklore studies

This category includes all those narratives that are limited to describe those cultural manifestations that today are associated with the Carnival of Barranquilla and that are part of the collective imagination. This category includes not only journalistic articles, but also texts written by folklore professionals that describe the origin of each of the dances, costumes and events. Although they are descriptive in nature, they always seek to highlight those elements that separate the Carnival of Barranquilla from other carnivals, highlighting and idealize those elements that are not repeated elsewhere, unlike the early narratives of the carnival that always seek to review the origin of the carnival through the common elements it has with other carnivals. Cultural narratives in folklore can include various types of expressions, such as tales, legends, myths, songs, proverbs, sayings, anecdotes, oral histories and any other form of storytelling that is important to the carnival. They are mainly narrated by folklorists, libraries, archives and museums, but also by government entities.

It can be found in books such as "Joselito Carnaval" by Édgar Rey Sinning (1992) where he makes a historical description of the cultural manifestations and scenarios of the Carnival, also in *Carnival of Barranquilla. Patrimonio musical y danzario del Caribe colombiano* [Carnival of Barranquilla. Musical and dance heritage of the Colombian Caribbean] by Rafael Bassi and Jairo Solano (2017) which mentions and talks about the musicians and musical genres that have been important for the Carnival of Barranquilla, and even in the digipak (or digibook, i.e. the booklet that accompanies a compact disc) of *Carnaval de Barranquilla. Cultura y tradición* [Carnival of Barranquilla. Culture and Tradition] which

[8] "This phenomenon has problematic consequences such as increasing social segregation and decreasing social mobility. But what is the most interesting from a sociological point of view, is how society accepted and consented to this socio-economic organization, which is seen as 'normal'. This issue raises questions about social class representations and processes of consent and power. Thus, Colombian society openly displays stratification and concedes to a hierarchical social order" (Fuller 2008:2). *Estratos* also affects the system of values of the classes, the artistic tastes, and the entertainment consumption, and create imaginaries among the different *estratos* that are right now very naturalize and demarcated. The above may be a consequence of the processes that each *estrato* have lived for more than three decades that end up sharing similar elements such as the urban landscape and relationships with their environment, and the identity values (Iriarte Diazgranados 2012), and that now emphasize the problems or privileges that are the result of shortages or abundance, and the standards of beauty and morality (Ángel Moreno 2016). Today, any behavior that breaks the parameters of the *estratos* is mocked with irony or criticized with distaste. It is common to hear phrases such as *se te notó el estrato* (look, how you show your *estrato*) to denote how your manners is not according to your "own" *estrato*; *no traiciones a tu estrato* (do not betray your *estrato*) to embarrass someone who wants to change his "own" *estrato,* even if the person in question 'is' *estrato* 1, 3 or 6, and the expression *subir* or *bajar de estrato* (e*strato* upgrade or downgrade), to sign that there has been a sudden change in behavior or that people unexpectedly have money or lost it.

explains the most outstanding music and dances of the carnival (Carnaval de Barranquilla S.A. 2013).

2.2.2.2. Carnival narratives from heritage studies

It is based on the narratives of carnival from the folklore studies; however, it focuses on the heritage value of such elements or cultural manifestations. They are narrated mainly by artists, cultural and heritage preservation organizations, as well as schools and governmental institutions, NGOs and international organizations that have an interest in preserving such manifestations and promoting them in collaboration with citizens. These stories reflect the beliefs and values of these traditions, in order to maintain the local carnival identity of the city that is transmitted from generation to generation.

Its quest to give meaning to heritage allows giving voice to many people who can enrich the reasons to safeguard these traditions, through strategies and alliances with many other actors that can support the sustainability of these manifestations. The Barranquilla Carnival is approached from this narrative through entities such as the Barranquilla Carnival Foundation and the Secretariat of Culture of Barranquilla, for example, through documents such as the "Plan of Action to Safeguard the Barranquilla Carnival", prepared by the Ministry of Culture and the Caribbean Cultural Observatory (2015) or through UNESCO communiqués.

2.2.2.3. Institutional carnival narratives

Like carnival narratives from heritage studies, institutional carnival narratives are also supported by narratives of carnival from the folklore studies. It is that specific information provided by governmental institutions, tourist assistance or media to the general public that attends, participates and is interested in what happens in the carnival. It is tourist information, promotion of events, calls for competitions, last minute announcements, safety warnings, notices for the promotion of civility and generally positive messages about what it means to live the carnival and the city of Barranquilla.

They are generally narratives that are promoted by public institutions or tourist agencies, by the entities in charge of security and are disseminated through pamphlets, press releases, mass media such as television and radio, the pages and social networks of the Mayor's Office of Barranquilla, Colombia or the organizers of the events, billboards and banners. An example of these narratives can be seen in the requirements to participate in the Orchestras Festival contest, in the statistical data of the economic gains obtained during the carnival, mobility information or in the tourist brochures that show historical facts or memories of the carnival that are important for the city or activities organized by the mayor's office with information of other events not related to the carnival.

2.2.2.4. Carnival narratives from Academia

They are narratives of a critical nature, made by scholars and experts in various disciplines such as anthropology, sociology, history, cultural studies, literature and ethnography, economics, among others. Through analysis, they seek to understand the carnival from deeper and contextualized perspectives, exploring its cultural, historical, social, political, economic and symbolic meaning. They are generally narratives presented in academic texts, however, they can also be easily perceived through interviews with experts and academics.

Some of the topics addressed by these narratives may be related to perspectives such as globalization, power studies, the role of pedagogy, gender and sexuality, participation, performance, symbolism and reflections on identity. There is the possibility of confusing this type of narratives with the definition of discourse according to White (1990), however, narratives only have the intention of communicating and transmitting a message that in this case is of a critical nature, while discourse has an element of persuasion.

2.2.3. Carnival narratives, established from the integration period

This period is related to the declaration of Declaration of the Carnival as a national heritage site in 2001 and as a world heritage site in 2003. This created the conditions for the development of an ever-growing mass tourism. As in other countries, Colombian Internet users witnessed the birth of social networks such as MySpace (2003), Facebook (2004), Youtube (2005), Whatsapp (2009), Instagram 2010 and TikTok (2016), which meant the birth of virtual communities that in turn began to use smartphones, tablets and other new technological equipment that accelerated information management and network interaction through apps and platforms with streaming content. These facilities forced the tightening of copyrights, however, the rapid crossing of opinions also allowed the presence of ideas such as those favoring the representation of minorities and gender equity.

2.2.3.1. Carnival Narratives on Social Networks

Explaining what happens in the carnival through social networks is new in the sense that these virtual spaces became popular since the advent of the new century (De la Hera 2021). Certainly, there are almost no studies done from this perspective. There is currently no study that analyzes the narratives of carnival music in social networks. However, in *La paradoja de Teseo: La representación del Carnaval de Barranquilla en Instagram* [The paradox of Theseus: The representation of the Barranquilla Carnival

on Instagram] (2020), Salge Ferro reviews how carnival is visually perceived on the internet, especially through a social network such as Instagram.

Salge Ferro reviewed the capture, coding and analysis of a specific set of images grouped in the tag #carnavaldebarranquilla on Instagram and contrasted his findings with an ethnographic work he did in 2019. Her idea was to understand the dynamics and behaviors of the people who used said tag in order to see how through their publications the Barranquilla Carnival was shown on Instagram. Their work reveals how the visual presentation of the carnival through that tag is mainly related to the individual or collective experience one has during the event. These narratives comprises the carnival within a festive context that is supported through faces, texts in the images and a certain palette of warm colors that are usually accompanied by elements of the carnival that are tirelessly repeated: the queens, the marimonda costume and the *cumbia* dance attire.

This narrative does not care about those concerns about safeguarding heritage, ignores the social, political and economic inequalities that are perceived in the carnival and also the diversity of a carnival to concentrate mainly on three elements, which are only a small part of what this carnival is. What is truly valid and authentic here is the lived experience.

2.3. Carnival representations from the perspective of globalization

The Carnival of Barranquilla, throughout its history has represented its different cultural manifestations in different ways taking into account the different contexts that were presented in each era. The intertwining of cultural influences, as well as those that over time began to arrive from other parts of the world added to the result of the representations in each period. Although the scope of the Carnival at this time is international, making its current representations recognized, we see today how there is still a process, integrating more elements and creating new forms.

2.3.1. Carnival representations, established from the formation period

In this period we can see how some of the most important traditions of carnival begin to be created and adopt the form we know today. For example, some of the costumes and dances such as *El Torito* date back to approximately 1880, as well as some of the central characters of the carnival, such as Rey Momo and the Carnival Queen (Rey Sinning 1992). Manifestations that today are tradition, such as the "Reading of *El Bando*", with which the carnival is initiated through "decrees", was created in 1876, or *La Batalla de Flores* [The Battle of Flowers], the most popular parade of the carnival, were created before 1930 (Ortega 2023; Pacheco Toscano 2020). Old photos from this period show how even many

of the costumes are closer to elaborations and attire such as gloves, lace, textile patterns, etc. produced directly in Europe (Ortega 2023).

2.3.2. Carnival representations, established from the institucionalization period

In this period all the previous traditions (costumes, activities, dances) are already more established in the event and many new ones appear. Some of the new activities that are adopted are *El Festival de Orquestas* [The festival of Orchestras] in 1969, *La Gran Parada* [The Great Parade] in 1967 and *La Guacherna* in 1974 (Castañeda 2024; Montenegro 2017; Romero Acosta 1999). Different entities are created to be in charge of the organization of the carnival such as *La Junta de Festejos del Carnaval* [the Carnival Festivities Board] (1938), *La Junta Organizadora del Carnaval* [Carnival Organizing Board] (1941 and 1958), *La Sociedad de Mejoras Públicas* [Public Improvement Society] (1942), *La Junta Municipal del Carnaval* [Municipal Carnival Board] (late 1940s), *La Junta Provisional de Turismo y Carnaval* [Provisional Tourism and Carnival Board] (1966), *La Junta Permanente del Carnaval y del Folclor Barranquillero* [Permanent Carnival and Barranquillero Folklore Board] (1970), *La Corporación Autónoma del Carnaval* [Carnival Autonomous Corporation] (1979), Carnival S. A. (1991) and *La Fundación Carnaval de Barranquilla* [Barranquilla Carnival Foundation] (1992), which all were mostly managed by prestigious personalities belonging to families that managed banking, industry and local commerce and had strong ties with Europe and the United States (Oliveros 2006). For this reason, it is understandable to see how foreign big band orchestras become very popular during carnivals, bringing foreign musical genres to Barranquilla. Television has also played an important role in the generation of representations, for example, in the creation of costumes inspired by highly notorious characters in this media, such as local, national and international entertainment personalities and politicians. Similarly, the carnival began to be presented on local channels with national coverage (Montes 2017).

2.3.3. Carnival representations, established from the integration period

While the carnival was declared national and international heritage, the development of technology had a strong impact on the Carnival representations. Carnival ceased to be presented only in media such as television, to be shown through the internet and social networks. At the same time, viral phenomena of digital platforms began to make their presence felt by integrating themselves into the Carnival representations. We are talking about popular music such as those using electronic sounds, but also about social media influencers (Caracol 2019; Palacio 2018). Critical voices against companies and brands began to be increasingly greater due to the prominence that these were having in front of the artistic manifestations proper to the carnival (Tubarco 2023; Oyaga de Luque 2023).

The work of Salge Ferro (2020) explains that social networks expanded the representation of carnival. This type of representation takes place in first person and is registered in both public and private spaces. Curiously, these elements of the carnival are confused with the advertising of brands of alcoholic beverages, communications, fuel, hotels, among others. This synergy is well extended given the large number of appearances in the photo captures with said tag made by Salge Ferro. The text explains that this representation ignores visions presented by the other types of representations already mentioned here.

2.4. Authenticity as discourse

For this section, it was important to examine the writings of Salge Ferro (2020) who identifies three major strands of the discourse on authenticity. To arrive at this, he resorts to the paradox of Theseus who wonders if when all the parts are replaced, an object remains the same. Salge Ferro explains that the first answer to this question is answered "from a conception tied to the Platonic tradition, every change in the materiality of the ship would imply a degradation of its being" (Salge Ferro 2020 : 52), in other words, keeping the ship without any alteration keeps it "authentic". On the other hand, he explains that in the process of replacing materials, methods can be used that allow its sustainability over time and this process of innovation is what should be considered "authentic". The last aspect stems from the subject and not from the object, i.e. authenticity is tied to the type of experience the subject has had when considering an element, context or situation as novel. This position, taken up by the author of heritage studies, is generated by the understanding that the relationship between an object and a subject can be "cold" (which requires a certificate, declaration, prior supporting act) or "warm" (which generates a strong bond in the subject without the need for a previous document or act to endorse it).

2.4.1. Essentialist authenticity

This aspect, also called real or objective authenticity, was explored by Kim, Oh, Lee & Lee (2018), Wesener (2017) and Wang (1999) considers authentic what can be associated with the adjectives genuine, real, true, uncompromising or absolute. This means that there is a strong binarism with what it considers the opposite, i.e. what is false, fraudulent, simulated, copy. The value of the object (element, context or situation) lies in its origin and the fact that it belongs to someone.

This concept is closely linked to Romantic Nationalism, which tries to rescue and enhance those mores that are considered authentic, unique, pure, and even vernacular (Abrahams 1993). Johann Gottfried Herder was the founder of this movement, and he described a set of tenets, for example, the existence of different historical ages in nations, which forms an independent cultural entity, whose parts are integrally related to form an organic whole and the necessity of every nationality to develop in accord

with its own innate abilities, geographical environment, and innate cultural elements (Wilson 1973). In the Carnival of Barranquilla this is observed in the iron stance of keeping certain traditions intact, this includes costumes, dances and carnival rites, such as always celebrating the end of the carnival with the death of a fictitious character called Joselito Carnaval.

2.4.2. Constructivist authenticity

The second variant refers to understanding authenticity as a developing element that is valued. Kim, Oh, Lee & Lee (2018), Wesener (2017) and Wang (1999) conceive this type of authenticity as a heritage under construction that watches over a social process of constant creation and recreation. In this respect, authenticity is measured in the beliefs, values and preferences that people negotiate and project onto themselves. For this reason, this view understands that authenticity is not static and may change over time.

This type of authenticity solves the problem of seeing certain elements, contexts or situations that are valued as simple photographs that must remain intact over time, which meant a broader vision of heritage as it was previously understood. In this way, national or international organizations were able to review their position on what should be studied, protected and celebrated, and that perhaps before was not taken care of in the best way despite its non-fluid value. Thus, rituals and ceremonies performed by individuals or collectives that are adjusted over the years for various reasons can be elements seen as authentic and not only the enclosures where such events take place that generally remain unchanged. This position strongly benefits the performative processes created from spontaneity and innovation over time. In the Carnival of Barranquilla this position can be observed when adaptations are made to the existing traditions, for example, the floats that used to be rather small and decorated with flowers, are now monumental and full of carnival motifs.

2.4.3. Experiental authenticity

The third variant, also called existential authentictity (Wesener 2017; Kim, Oh, Lee & Lee 2018; Yi, Lin, Jin & Luo 2017), occurs when relating to a manifestation and receiving an authentic experience with elements, contexts or situations that are not necessarily authentic for other people. This depends on the subject's perception, subjective and intrapersonal or as something shared, communal and interpersonal, particularly in the context of tourism, cultural encounters, and consumption. It focuses on the extent to which an individual's experience of a place, event, or product aligns with their expectations, desires, and perceptions of what is considered authentic.

This also indicates that for there to be a type of authentic experience it is important to know the current context of the individual or collective that considers the elements, contexts, or situations as unique. Thus, a person who has had many experiences similar to what he or she considers authentic may do so based on comparisons. In the Carnival of Barranquilla this can be seen in the photos that people post on social networks such as Instagram during a carnival event in which they make explicit that this period was particularly special or unique in their life.

3. Methodology

Having explained what the narratives, representations and discourses are, understanding the development of the first two terms (narratives and representation) taking into account a globalization approach in the carnival, and emphasizing the need to reflect and identify the different narratives and representations about Carnival due to the interrelationship that these may have with any discourse, especially those that are of interest for this work, which are the discourses of authenticity, it is time to introduce our case study, the *comparsa* "La Puntica No Má", with its own narratives and representations. However, it is important to first explain the methodology used to establish contact and get to know the group that served as a reference for this research.

The proposed methodology involves first clarifying the type and methodological approach that has been chosen, then how the data will be obtained to answer these questions, the schedule of activities carried out and finally an explanation of how the data will be analyzed and interpreted.

3.1. Type and methodological approach

The methodological design was a mixed case study that combined both qualitative and quantitative elements. Due to the nature of the proposed project, the methodology chosen follows the lines of "participant observation". It can be defined as "one of the several methods that fit into the general category of qualitative research" and consists of "structured and semi-structured interviewing, pure observation and the collection and analysis of text" (DeWalt & DeWalt 2011: 2). According to DeWalt & DeWalt, the importance of this methodology is mainly because:

i) it allows for better quality of the data obtained, since much of the information that exists is tacit and must be gained through empirical processes;
ii) it allows a better quality in the interpretation of data, especially with those related to non-verbal communication, but also considering the closeness one has with the people with whom one interacts and who are the source of data, so that one, as a researcher, can anticipate reactions and responses of different natures;

iii) it consolidates personal relationships in the case of long-term research, which can provide greater depth and detail of data and be important in the event of wanting to continue with research in the future; and
iv) it encourages the formulation of new research questions.

This methodology allows to make more sense of the context due to the level of commitment of the researcher, who participates directly in the research events, and because of the interaction he/she has with the subjects who also participate in them. In this sense, the researcher presents himself/herself as a participant and at the same time as an observer. This does not mean that the methodology focused solely on qualitative data, since part of the information analyzed was taken from data that were quantified through surveys and other mechanisms.

To carry out a participant observation meant for the researcher to apply to be part of the group during the 2023 edition of the carnival. Permission was granted as long as the researcher went through all the regulatory process that the group has in order to receive membership. For this reason it was necessary to present an original design of a costume according to the theme chosen by the group for the year 2023, make a review of the design concept and explain how a character would be developed based on the costume and design, i.e. the performative element. In the call for entries they were emphatic that the proposal had to be in line with the *comparsa*'s standards. The slogan of the *comparsa* of the 2023 edition was "Flower me the seed", a somewhat ambiguous phrase that makes clear sexual references, and its theme pointed to the collective creation of a garden with all its elements: plants, birds, stones, insects, fungi, etc. Once the proposal (see in Appendix F) was approved, the next step was the payment of money to secure a place in the 2023 edition.

Another element to consider is that, in this case, the researcher was born and raised in the city of Barranquilla. This assumes that the researcher has prior experience and knowledge of the city which could be an advantage in having a deeper understanding of the culture, history and social dynamics of the community. There could also be concerns about unconscious biases due to ingrained preconceptions about the city, the carnival, and the *comparsa*, which is their case study. In turn, the researcher is perceived as part of the community or not depending on his socioeconomic reality and previous relationships with community members.

Finally, there were ethical considerations for the research, such as informed consent, confidentiality, respect for the participants and the handling of sensitive data.

3.2. Data collection

Both primary and secondary sources were used for data collection. The primary sources focused on surveys, observations and interviews with members of the *comparsa*, both managers and active participating members of the *comparsa*. Secondary sources were mainly books, documents or web pages, among others. Below is a table with the techniques, means and scope of analysis for each methodological instrument.

Technique	Instrument	Context / Medium	Scope of analysis
Interviews with members of the La Puntica No Ma' community	Cuestionarie	In situ, recorded	Opinions, values
Surveys with members of the La Puntica No Ma' community	Opinion poll	Survey platform	Opinions, values
Review of Whatsapp group conversations of La Puntica No Ma'	Whatsapp app	Social media	Opinions, values
Review of music playlists shared or made	Music streaming applications such as Youtube, Spotify, etc.	Social media	Opinions, values
Observation	Observation guide/ Audio and text notes/ recordings	In situ	Values
Documental analysis: Books, magazines, official information of public and privat institutions of the carnival	Content analysis	Internet, social media, libraries, museums	Descriptions, perspectives, history of art

Table 2. Methodological elements taken into account for this investigation.

3.3. Schedule of activities

Below are the activities that the researcher attended and collected data such as interviews, observations, photos and videos.

Date	Place	Activity	Description
Friday, February 17, 2023, 8:00 p.m.	Casa Puntera (Headquarters of the *comparsa*) Address: Carrera 59 # 64 - 112 (Barranquilla)	**Bracelet-Giving Ritual**	It served as a pre-meeting in which the members of the *comparsa* received indications about the logistics and details about the activities that were organized. The bracelets identifying all members as part of the *comparsa* were handed out. An evening party was held.
Saturday, February 18,	Casa Puntera (Headquarters of the *comparsa*)	**Meeting before the parade of "La Batalla**	All the members of the *comparsa* were summoned in the morning in order to adjust the costumes and make-up. Snacks

2023, 8:00 a.m.	Address: Carrera 59 # 64 - 112 (Barranquilla)	**de Flores" [Battle of Flowers] parade**	and drinks were served, and buses were hired to transport them to the site of the great parade of the Battle of Flowers.
Saturday, February 18, 2023, 12:00 m.	Via 40 Barranquilla Industrial Zone	**Great "Batalla de Flores" [Battle of Flowers] parade**	Main event of the *comparsa* in which the characters parade and show their costumes, under the slogan "Floréame la Pepita". Due to logistical problems, the group began to parade after 6:00 p.m., which generated a lot of discomfort among the members of the group.
Saturday, February 18, 2023, 7:00 p.m.	"Edgar Rentería" Baseball Stadium Parking Lot	***Verbena* party "El Jardín de las Malicias"**	At the end of the parade, all the members of the *comparsa* went on foot to the paqueadero of one of the main stadiums of the city where they were greeted with soup. After eating and resting, they started the *verbena* party organized by the *comparsa*, which this year was called "El Jardín de las Malicias" [The Garden of Malice]. The attendees did not take off their costumes, the party was attended by thousands of people and had a large stage where groups performed.
Monday, February 20, 2023, 3:00 p.m.	Casa Puntera (Headquarters of the *comparsa*) Address: Carrera 59 # 64 - 112 (Barranquilla)	**Activity for Punteritos**	Pedagogical activity organized for the children of the members of the *comparsa* in order to create a generational relay. The children of this seedbed were called "punteritos". They did artistic activities such as painting and make-up.
Tuesday, February 21, 2023, 4:00 p.m.	Carrera 54 Close to Parque de los Fundadores (meeting place)	**Joselito Carnival Parade**	*La Puntica No Má'* and *Disfrázate Como Quieras* joined forces to perform in the Joselito Carnaval parade, which marks the end of Carnaval. This event was used by both collective costume *comparsa*s to protest the poor logistics of the Carnival organizers, launching harsh accusations through banners, *letanías*[9] and booing at the judges and organizers of the Carnival.

Table 3. Schedule of activities during the carnival

3.4. Data analysis and interpretation

After presenting the *comparsa La Puntica No Má'* in the next chapter, it is time to show what was found given the objectives of the project and in order to generate a data analysis and its subsequent interpretation, it was necessary to address the research questions, which are "**How can discourses on authenticity be identified through the music listened to and enjoyed by the members of a carnival *comparsa*?**" and "**What discourses on authenticity about the Carnival of Barranquilla can currently be recognized in the music listened to and enjoyed by the members of the same collective costume troupe, such as *La Puntica no má'*?**" In reviewing the research questions, we note that there are certain

[9] *Letanías* are "verses that allude to Catholic prayers in which they criticize, satirize or mock characters and issues that are part of the media agenda locally, nationally and internationally" (Morales 2023).

objectives that must be addressed in a certain order in order to be able to respond to what is being investigated in this work.

In order to answer the first question it is important to 1) review the relationship between *La Puntica No Má' comparsa* and music; 2) examine in detail what the members say about this music (narratives); 3) inspect how these genres are represented within the *comparsa* (representations); 4) to make a triangulation between the narratives and the representations to identify discursive approaches to authenticity in those musics with more roots, and 5) to observe coincidences or discrepancies within the members, especially towards the new members of the *comparsa*, with whom it could be ascertained whether there was any type of coercion, influence or persuasion, direct or indirect, essential elements to transmit a discourse. Finally, and in order to answer the second question, it is necessary to review whether those discursive approaches to authenticity in the most deeply rooted musics can be related to the three discursive variants explored in the theoretical framework.

4. Case of study: *La Puntica No Má'*

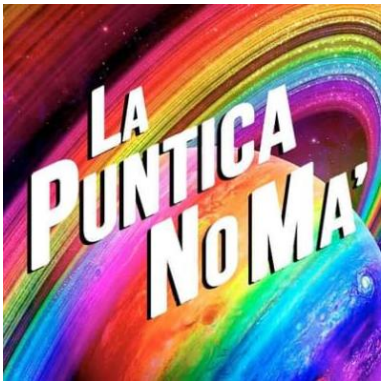


Illustration 1. Logo of *La Puntica No Má'.*

La Puntica No Má', or simply *"La Puntica",* is a collective costume *comparsa* of Barranquilla Carnival[10]. For the collective costume groups, the creation of the costumes and their interpretation during the carnival are the most important elements. Other collective costume *comparsa*s, which are still active today, are *Disfrázate Como Quieras,* whose former members of *La Puntica* they call *comparsa madre* [mother *comparsa*], since they were members of the latter who created *La Puntica No Má'*; there are also *La Nave de l@s Loc@s* and *El Desacato, comparsa*s that broke away from *La Puntica No Má'*, so we could say that they are "daughter" *comparsa*s - or granddaughter *comparsa*s, depending on who name it (Pinilla Acevedo 2023).

La Puntica No Má' defines itself on its website as "a collective performance, a meeting space within the Carnival of Barranquilla. A joyful and spiritual experience that encourages you to explore your inner self and live art as a creative engine. Experiencing it leaves you transformed and inspired" (La Puntica No Má' 2023). In the case of *La Puntica No Má'*, each year there is a theme assigned by the organizers,

[10] In this carnival there are other types of *comparsa*s, for example, the *comparsa*s of dances that have been divided into patrimonial (for example, *Danza del Congo Grande* and *Danza de los Arlequines*) and popular (Danza del Garabato or Danza del Monocuco; the *comparsa*s of litanies; the comedies (as when a group of people represent the fictitious death of Joselito Carnaval on the last day of the festival) and since some years also, also of puppets (Lora Cueto 2022).

and all the members of the *comparsa* or those who wish to be part of it must design a character, more than a simple costume, related to the theme, adjusting to the aesthetics and idiosyncrasy of this *comparsa*, elaborate it and interpret it. There is the possibility of presenting oneself in a "joint costume" with other members, which means leaving individuality behind and elaborating a pair or a group of articulated costumes (Pinilla Acevedo 2023). Each edition has a slogan that is associated with the theme of the year. It is usually a play on words or double entendre with erotic/sexual references. The last two *verbena*s (big carnival night parties/concerts) organized by *La Puntica* had also their own name. The last slogans were:

- 2012: El Fin del mundo
- 2013: La chucha fluorescente
- 2014: La Quinceañera
- 2015: ¡Qué rica estoy!
- 2016: La Puntica coronada
- 2017: La raja en el espejo
- 2018: Dame tu cosita
- 2019: El pechuchi bestial
- 2020: Ay Puntica, vente, vente
- 2021: -Cancelled due to the coronavirus pandemic-
- 2022: La Mondonguera Galáctica | La Estrechita (*Verbena*)
- 2023: Floréame la Pepita | El Jardín de las Malicias (*Verbena*)

This collective costume troupe was born in 1999 and was an idea materialized by Daniel Angulo, Ingrid Jamis and plastic artist Flavia Rosales as a fresh and alternative way to connect tradition with contemporary art aesthetics. Since its creation, emphasis has been placed on the role of drum music in the meetings and parties that took place in the house of Daniel Angulo, who was the first director of the *comparsa*, and his wife Ingrid Jamis, to determine the way in which the group would express itself during the carnivals. In 2004 Flavia Rosales and Francisco González took over the direction. Today, the *comparsa* has a board of directors that is composed of an artistic direction, which is in charge of everything related to artistic curatorship, makeup, music, decoration of events, etc., and an administrative direction that is in charge of marketing, networks, accounting, etc. This board of directors is accompanied by an assembly, which is made up solely of the founders of the *comparsa*, with whom they meet to make the important decisions of the collective. *La Puntica No Ma'* has expanded its mission objectives as it not only seeks to have an impact with its proposal during its participation within the Carnival spaces, but also carries out events such as parties outside the Carnival period and creates cultural projects related to themes such as Carnival and the arts, such as the recording of a musical album (Carvajal 2023; La Puntica No Ma' 2023).

La Puntica No Má' is characterized by its double meaning, its sexual humor and its aesthetic proposals that have always stood out since its foundation for being considered daring, ingenious, irreverent and uncomfortable (Angulo 2023). Their website explains that *La Puntica No Má'* is "the upside-down world where all norms and rules are subverted to give way to celebration and excessive ingestion, hierarchical suppression, laughter, play, inversions, degradations and ambivalence" (La Puntica No Má' 2023). In a certain way it represents the act of embracing carnival according to the classical interpretation of carnival. The very name of the *comparsa*, in English "just the tip", is a play on words as it has clear erotic/sexual references. *La Puntica No Má'* seeks to vindicate the history that has been built through power structures that come from colonial times and that have molded society in such a way that favors some and oppresses others. The *comparsa*'s website recalls that Caribbean ancestors lived through "colonial and cultural domination and the various threats against the expression of identity to which they were subjected. This search for identity is undertaken mainly and vehemently from the artistic field" (La Puntica No Má' 2023).

There is a vocabulary specific to the *comparsa*. For example, the member or everything related to the *comparsa* is called *punteros*. New members of the *comparsa* are called *vírgenes* [virgins]. There are also certain sayings, litanies and iconic places for this group. The *verbena* (carnival night party) of *La Puntica* on Carnival Saturday night has become a very referenced event. The truth is that year after year the *comparsa* seems to remind us that it is constantly creating and inventing its own rites, coinciding with its saying that dates back to the early years "tradition in evolution". These values must be followed by the members of the *comparsa* especially by the captains of the *comparsa* who are chosen each year by the council.

To be a member of *La Puntica* is important to fill out a form, in which you must enter your personal and contact information, if you know someone in the *comparsa* and submit the proposed character (costume + performance) according to the theme of the following year. Additionally, a fee must be paid, which varies according to nationality and years, which for nationals costed $472,500 (cost in Colombian *pesos*, the local currency) in 2023, a rather high amount for many Colombians, considering that the member must also build a character whose costume can cost quite a lot of money. For foreigners the fee is higher.

4.1. Narratives: Relationship of the *comparsa* with the music

Daniel Angulo, founder of *La Puntica No Ma'* explains that the *comparsa* was born in part thanks to the music and the type of music chosen was decisive to mark a milestone and a separation from the *mother comparsa*, that is "Disfrázate como quieras", of which he was a member for many:

> [The music] was also one of the crucial elements that made me decide [to leave] the *comparsa madre*[11]. [...] For me, for example, it seemed to me that we needed the beat of the drum. The beat of the tambora. Because it seemed to us, it seemed to me, that it [drum music] was completely tribal[12]. It took me back to my roots and I always had the longing that if I created a *comparsa* the main music would be based on *cumbia* (Angulo 2023).

To understand this, it would be necessary to explain that the music that characterized the mother *comparsa* was different:

> They were always looking for tradition, which is also a traditional music within the Carnival, which is the porro. It is a music of winds, which is from the savannahs of Bolivar and Sucre. It was a spectacular music. But I felt a longing for the rhythms with which I grew up (Angulo 2023).

The interviews showed how *La Puntica* sponsored *cumbia de Chorrera* (also known as *millo de Chorrera*)[13] and made it part of their existence:

> From the beginning, *La Puntica* has always gone out with *millo de Chorrera*, that is, the typical folk music of the Atlantic is a fundamental part. And that is the basis of the music of the *comparsa*. *Millo de Chorrera* has accompanied us during these 24, 25 years that the *comparsa* has been going uninterruptedly. Even during the pandemic some activities were carried out to support them [the performing musicians] there in Chorrera. They... Actually *millo de Chorrera* is the musical root of the *comparsa*. [...] Francis, who was also in the group for a long time, was key, Francisco González went to Chorrera [Atlántico]... I think it was thanks to him that we got *millo de Chorrera* because he was always going everywhere looking for new things to bring to the carnival. [...] The music and heritage of *La Puntica* is definitely *millo* music. In other words, *millo* music, *tambora* music. That is what accompanied us and what will accompany us for the rest of the years, which is part of the natural folklore of the carnival. *Millo*. Really *millo*, and *millo de Chorrera* in particular, is our musical standard (Pinilla Acevedo 2023).

Cumbia de Chorrera is present in all the spaces of the *comparsa*. It accompanies all the members of *La Puntica no Má'* during the parades, but it is also present at parties and *verbena*s (carnival night party). The connection that *La Puntica No Má'* has with *cumbia de Chorrera* is such that the *comparsa* has considered presenting a project to record an album paying tribute to this music:

> We formulated a project for the Ministry of Culture [of Colombia] that was to make a record of *cumbia de Chorrera* to preserve the tradition, understanding that [only] one of the founders was left. The last one alive is quite old, so it would be like leaving a physical legacy (Carvajal 2023).

However, the interviews also show that the *comparsa* was open to all kinds of musical fusions and experimentation from the very beginning:

> At the beginning we never hired, we were the musicians who did the whole process because that's how the meetings started in the backyard of my house, which was always the hub where we all met. Then everything was a music laboratory in the park. We rehearsed all the time. Musicians from everywhere. But our main base was the native instrumentation of *cumbia*: *llamador*, *alegre*, maracas.... And we also often used *gait*as, flutes, sometimes we hired, no, we invited a wind band from Usiacurí or something like that... we made a fusion between jazz and *cumbia* based on that kind of research that musicians did

[11] In English, mother comparsa.
[12] Referring to the fact that it referred to the ancestors.
[13] Chorrera is a district of the municipality of Juan de Acosta, in the Department of Atlántico (Colombia).

> in the 50's. [...] We made variations of all that, but almost always what accompanied the music we made was based on *cumbia*. We made our own compositions and *jazz sessions* (Angulo 2023).

Daniel Angulo recognizes that today *cumbia* music is being displaced by other more contemporary musical genres, especially *champeta*. What is interesting is how, especially for the older members, this situation can be worrisome, but at the same time they seem to accept it:

> The new *punteros*, I imagine, are with the new trends of social platforms that a song suddenly becomes a hit overnight without passing through the sieve of popular acceptance. More than anything else, the very electronic trend among the youth also takes away a lot of the indigenous roots in passing. Maybe the DJs are to blame for that. But I wouldn't blame them... Rock invaded us in the 60s until the 90s. We have that relationship of values too, but what I think is that African rhythms began to arrive to carnival like *champeta* and all these rhythms have overshadowed what is *cumbia* and *bullerengue*. They have become completely commercial issues. They are commercial hits that everybody repeats and repeats and repeats. Of course, it becomes a viral issue (Angulo 2023).

The music as well as other artistic elements such as costumes and make-up is coined within one of the most characteristic slogans of the *comparsa*, "tradition in evolution". This has allowed it to adopt new sound manifestations since the foundation of the *comparsa*:

> Actually, *millo de Chorrera* is the musical root of the *comparsa*. Later, when I was here as director, we took on a theme, a term that is an *evolving tradition*, but that already came from before due to the influence that contemporary tropical rhythms had on the carnival.

On the other hand, there is the *verbena* of *La Puntica*, which at this moment already has the dimensions of a multitudinous concert. These *verbena*s have featured artists such as Guetto Cumbé, Abelardo Carbonó, Bomba Estéreo and Systema Solar (Carvajal 2023; Pinilla Acevedo 2023). 2023 featured Wganda Kenya as the central artist, accompanied by Uproot Andy, Soukilla Allstars, Don Alirio and Busy Twist. The warm-up was in charge of La Sonora Valenzuela, Calamidades Lola and Passion Fruit. The interesting thing here is that in the audience was located the "rueda de *cumbia*", a space where musicians and attendees form a circle in charge of the members of "Los Originales de Chorrera", the group that always accompanies *La Puntica* in all its important events. This contrast between the old and the new is explained by Georghe Pinilla when he says:

> *La Puntica* is always trying to rescue the traditional, but teleported towards the future... Towards a musical future to endure it, to endure in time and to preserve it in time so that future generations also do not lose it and find it and have it present all the time in the parade or in the moments in which the *comparsa* is in force (Pinilla Acevedo 2023).

Today *La Puntica No Má'* also holds parties at different times other than carnival, and they can be in any place or city other than Barranquilla. The proposals that are presented at the parties coincide musically with what happens in the carnival activities because it has sought to create an identity seal.

4.2. Representations: Musical performances by *La Puntica No Má'*

What has been written so far about *La Puntica No Má'* corresponds to his narratives, taking into account what is written on the internet and social networks and from the point of view of people who have had decision-making roles in *La Puntica*. In this work, for example, it was possible to interview founding member Daniel Angulo, general producer Orlando Carvajal and Jorge Luis Pinilla, also known as Georghe Pinilla, who was the director of the *comparsa* for two years in a row. Everything they exposed coincides with what is reported in the official pages and social networks of *La Puntica No Má'*, but also with journalistic notes and videos related to the *comparsa*.



Illustration 2. Poster of the verbena party of La Puntica No Má' 2023

To address the discourses of authenticity in the music of the *comparsa*, which is the main purpose of this paper, it is important to first exhibit some representations of the music that is associated in some way with the collective, limiting only in its description (the analysis will be done in the next chapter). These following representations are considered iconic and go beyond what is produced by the carnival organizers, as many of the *comparsa* members are musically active artists who have even depicted their participation and emotions while being in *La Puntica No Má'*.

4.2.1. Los Originales de Chorrera

As previously mentioned, *cumbia* from Chorrera is always present in the activities of *La Puntica No Má'*. Their musical interventions are very significant and appreciated by the members of *La Puntica No Má'*. During the carnival it was present in parades and *verbena* and something very striking is that despite being surrounded by people who created very colorful costumes, the attire of the musicians was maintained as tradition dictates that white shirts and pants, red sashes and the *vueltiao* hat.[14]

During the 2023 parade they did not walk, but were on the float that is arranged for the most important people of the *comparsa*, that is to say the captains. Next to them were DJs Madame Vacile and The Busy Twist who played music when they were not playing. Their performance was amplified by

[14] This is the traditional attire of the men. The group that performed in the activities of *La Puntica* during the Carnival during the year 2023 was composed only of men.

loudspeakers attached to the structure of the float, which was decorated with plant motifs. During the *verbena*, Los Originales de Chorrera were on a *rueda de cumbia* and performed their music interspersed with the musicians on the stage. The contrast between the music coming from the stage and the other coming from the audience was interesting, not only acoustically but also because the focus was not only on the musicians but also on the attendees themselves who became dancers.

On Daniel Angulo's Youtube channel it is possible to watch a video in which DJ Uproot Andy has a meeting with the group in Chorrera and they play traditional instruments over an audio track created by the American artist (Angulo 2017). The track is clearly inspired by the rhythmic pattern of *cumbia* although it includes certain electronic sounds. At the beginning of the video it can be appreciated that there are difficulties in coordinating both proposals, however, as the minutes go by it manages to achieve a fusion that everyone seems to be happy and comfortable playing. In fact, at the end of the video you can see children dancing.

In an interview with Orlando Carvajal, he explained that one of *La Puntica No Má's* projects is to record the music of Los Originales de Chorrera, taking advantage of the fact that one of its founding members is still alive. Carvajal expressed that the project has already been drafted and that they are looking for financing.

4.2.2. La Quinceañera

However, tradition in music is also subject to experimentation. Daniel Angulo, founder of the *comparsa*, artist and musician, is enthusiastic about creating musical fusions. He himself created some songs that are part of *La Puntica's* own repertoire using elements of *cumbia* or musical genres related to *cumbia*, given its instrumentation. "La Quinceañera" is one of those songs that he composed and recorded and is part of that collection and is a fusion between a *son de garabato* and some verses of litanies. The *son de garabato*, also called *chandé*, is a musical genre that shares the instrumentation of *cumbia*, while the *letanías* are "verses that allude to Catholic prayers in which they criticize, satirize or mock characters and issues that are part of the media agenda locally, nationally and internationally" (Morales 2023) and are very traditional of the Carnival of Barranquilla. This song explains the origin of the *comparsa's* name. In the words of Daniel Angulo, the litanies are like couplets... they are four verses, which coordinate[15] between [verse] 1 and [verse 3], and [verse] 2 and [verse] 4. The name was

[15] rhyme

hard to find and I was making those litanies and when I finished it I said 'That's it, *La Puntica No Má'*!" (Bomba Estéreo b, 2014).

Original text (Spanish)	Translation (English)
Que mañana te pago	That tomorrow I'll pay you
Que ya no bebo más	That I don't drink anymore
La última y nos vamos	The last one and we're leaving
La puntica no más.	*Just the tip*.
Son las cuatro mentiras	These are the four lies
de todo carnaval	of every carnival
suelta ya la locura	let your madness out
y vente a *La Puntica*.	and come to *La Puntica*.

Table 4. Original Spanish lyrics and Spanish translation of "La Quinceañera" (Angulo 2023); see the full text in Appendix G.

Here again we see that *La Puntica No Má'*, under the ears of its founder, creates new forms based on the confrontation of two traditions of the Barranquilla Carnival (*millo* format and *letanías*). This music has however certain deliberate modifications such as the use of reverberation and unnatural repetition of sounds such as words or exclamations.

4.2.3. Qué Bonito

In the interviews conducted, Georghe Pinilla mentions that for the consolidation of the new musical sonorities of the *comparsa*, the presence in the *comparsa* of musicians whose projects grew along with the *comparsa* was important.

> Proof of this was that Li Saumet with the group Bomba Estéreo have a song that names the *comparsa*: "Remember that last night in Carnaval de Barranquilla, remember that we danced in *La Puntica*". Then, there was already a more than generational leap, a very important musical leap that led to hear other sounds in the *comparsa* (Pinilla Acevedo 2023).

Li (Liliana) Saumet is a singer of the group "Bomba Estéreo" and a member of the *comparsa*. She was captain of *La Puntica No Má'* in 2013, when the theme song of the *comparsa* was called "La Chucha Fluorescente". The lyrics (See in Appendix H) that Georghe Pinilla paraphrases in his speech, belong to "Qué Bonito" (Bomba Estéreo 2014) which is a *champeta* and according to him, this *champeta* is considered as one of the songs with which the members of the *comparsa* feel most identified.

> "Qué Bonito", that is definitely the song of *La Puntica*, "Qué Bonito" by Bomba Estéreo, that has become the anthem of the literal *comparsa*, thanks to Li and Bomba for having made that song (Pinilla Acevedo 2023).

Along with the release of this song, a short web series was published, divided into three episodes, which explains the background of this song and pays homage to the carnival and introduces *La Puntica No Má'*. The video includes the following texts:

> The carnival of Barranquilla, the main celebration of a city embedded in the Colombian Caribbean, is the place where stories, characters and songs take on a life of their own thanks to the genuine encounter between those who live it, enjoy it and dance it tight.
>
> "Qué bonito" is a respectful, but very tasty, hymn offered by Bomba Estéreo to that carnival that between plazas and picós, between *champeta* and salsa, has become a source of inspiration for music.
>
> A feast that brings together different generations that carry it in their DNA since the nineteenth century and this time we see through the eyes of one of the most important alternative Colombian bands today.
>
> In the midst of the encounter that represents the carnival, order seeks chaos and thus initiatives like *La Puntica No Má'* are born, a collective that serves as a new voice and option for Barranquilleros and curious people who come from all corners of the planet to get to know it.
>
> The Barranquilla Carnival is much more than what the world has known about it through conventional channels of communication. While it is the ideal excuse to get up the naguas and take to the streets of La Arenosa[16], it is a whole culture that gravitates around joy, music and enjoyment.
>
> Different faces has a national party like the Carnival of Barranquilla. The alternative scene is one of the 11 and the Panamerika Stage at the Verbetrónik party is the best representative of this face of the carnival.
>
> We understand what we are because we know where we come from. "Qué Bonito" is an interpretation of rhythmic ancestors such as *champeta*, which we translate into sounds of today.
>
> Bomba Estéreo's place as a spearhead of the Latin American alternative circuit is directly related to the respect we feel for sound roots like *champeta* and the *picó* movement, to whom we pay tribute with songs like "Qué Bonito".
>
> And the fact is that "Qué Bonito" has been for us a part of this history. That of Colombian and Latin American music.

Particularly, in the second episode the emphasis is on *La Puntica No Má'*. There Li Saumet explains:

> I go out every year in a *comparsa* called *La Puntica No Má'* that you already know and my way of living Carnival is to be with my friends, go to Carnival things, La noche del Río, etc. etc. and participate in the *comparsa*. That's all for us. [...] This is a party that is made for you to enjoy. For the meat, right? Carnival, for you to let it all out and let it all out. So when they say to the people from the coast "Come on, let's go! Imagine: If the costeño who is normally a rumbero is told "well, you have a week now [to rumbees]... then it's crazy, it's indescribable. It's like a feeling that only people can understand when they come here. That's why it's the best motto in the world: "He who lives it, enjoys it.[17]

4.2.4 Carnavalera

[16] This is also how Barranquilla is known.

[17] It is the most famous motto of the Carnival of Barranquilla.

For *La Puntica's* 2019 *verbena* party, there was a big surprise for attendees as the bands Bomba Estéreo and Systema Solar came together to play and record part of what would become the video for the song "Carnavalera". Like Bomba Estéreo, Systema Solar is another musical band that is in the imagination of the *punteros*. They have participated in *La Puntica No Má'* events including the parades. Precisely the "Carnavalera" video shows a great part of all these activities that they were part of that year during the carnival, it shows the stops, the concerts, the *verbenas*, even the bus that transports the participants of *La Puntica* to the parades. In the video the musicians show the outfits they wore according to the theme of that year which was "El Pechuchi Bestial", which sought to relate the *punteros* with their inner animal.

In the video, directed by Pablo Crutzen Díaz, "are present the characters and icons representative of the Carnival of Barranquilla like *La Marimonda* representing joy, powerful mythological beings… like *El Tigre Africano* and *El Tigrillo*, the *K-Z*, where the musical orchestras put the carnival goers to dance, the *Negra Bollonga* and, representing the *Garabato* dance, *La Muerte*" (Sony Music 2019). In an interview for Latin-American Sony Music Walter Hernández, vocalist of Systema Solar explained that "with 'Carnavalera', we enjoy and share the challenge to creativity that unites humanity in a rooted ritual of celebration, which is not exhausted in 4 days. Carnaval will always be", Simón Mejía, founder of Bomba Estéreo, complemented saying that "Carnaval is the maximum expression of what we are as a culture in Latin America and Colombia, a mixture of powerful races that coexist under the enjoyment of music in communion and without social, sexual or racial distinctions. The world should be like this, every day" (Sony Music 2019).

The lyrics of the song speak of the joy of living life during carnival:

Original (Spanish)	**Translation (English)**
Carnavales con los bailes, con la carnavalera	Carnivals with the dances, with the *carnavalera*
Siempre la gozadera, pásame la Maizena	Always having fun, pass me the carnival foam
Que la vaina está buena, ven, llega	The thing is good, come, come
Po-po-po-ponte pilo en la juega	be ready for the game
Mira que la vida entera es pa' pasarla plena	Look that the whole life is to spend it to the fullest
Y tú, cómo tienes tu espíritu, tu virtud	And you, how you have your spirit, your virtue
Tu salud, de la luz, qué felicidad que la vida da	Your health, of the light, what happiness life gives you
Si está encendida	If it is shinning
Alegría todos los días, que eso va, papá	Joy every day, that it goes, daddy
Se desborde ya, la felicidad, en el carnaval, yo quiero bailar	Happiness is already overflowing, in the carnival, I want to dance
Con la carnavalera	With the *carnavalera*
Yo traigo alegría pa' mi corazón, pa' tu corazón, pa' los corazones	I bring joy to my heart, to your heart, to all hearts.
(Carnavalera)	(Carnavalera)
Yo traigo alegría pa' mi corazón, pa' tu corazón, pa' los corazones	I bring joy for my heart, for your heart, for all hearts

Table 4. Original Spanish lyrics and Spanish translation of "Carnavalera" (See in Appendix I).

4.3. Results of data collection of *La Puntica No Má'*

4.3.1. Quantitative data

Within the data collected there is data that could be quantified. These were the surveys and the items shared by Whatsapp groups.

4.3.1.1. Surveys

The surveys conducted among the members of the *comparsa* provide an interesting sample of what *La Puntica No Má'* is all about. A total of 41 people responded to the survey (See in Appendix J). The questionnaire was sent to the members a week before the beginning of the carnival through a mass mailing sent by the organization of *La Puntica No Má'*. The survey was available in Spanish and English, for those not fluent in the local language. Broadly speaking, it can be said that both the residence and place of birth of the members is mostly Colombia. However, there is a considerable component of foreign population or members living abroad, which is around 20%. The age range with the highest participation in the *comparsa* is between 30 and 39 years of age, almost 50% of the total. In terms of gender, the surveys gave fairly balanced results if we consider only the categories of male and female, however, there was one person who presented himself as non-binary. When people were asked about their sexual orientation we see that approximately 58 percent of them define themselves as heterosexual, which indicates that the rest could fall into the "LGBT+" category: 13 people presented themselves as homosexual, 3 people as bisexual and 1 person preferred not to answer. In terms of socioeconomic strata, we see that the *comparsa* participants live mainly in households considered upper middle (4) and upper middle (5 and 6) strata. A little less of the respondents (46.34%) were "virgins", that is, they paraded for the first time with the *comparsa*, for 29.26% this was their second time, 14.63% of the respondents would parade for the third time and 3.7% have an experience of more than 5 years.

When reviewing the results of the surveys made to the members of the *comparsa*, it is important to highlight the preference for the traditional folk music format (*Grupo de millo* or *gaita*) and the picó music format. When members were asked "With which of these carnival music formats do you feel most identified? Choose two.", the two results that received the most votes were the *millo* or *gaita* group (90.24%) and *picó* (70.73%). It is striking that out of the 41 respondents, 25 chose precisely these two formats at the same time as the most familiar, that is, 60.97% of the respondents. This indicates that both formats are well positioned and are not in a context of polarization. What is interesting is

that 96.15% of those who chose *picó* also chose the *millo* or *gaita* group, while only 64.10% of those who indicated the *millo* or *gaita* group also indicated *picó*. This would indicate that there is a greater attachment to *cumbia*.

On the other hand, when people were asked "What music genres do you expect to hear at the carnival (in order of preference, the first one being the one you like the most)?" the genre that was most repeated as the favorite or first choice was *cumbia* (17), while *champeta* appears 5 times. Curiously, the roles were reversed when we noticed that the second favorite music genre that respondents most expected to hear was precisely *champeta* (13), while *cumbia* appears 6 times. If we consider that respondents had possibilities to name this genre, since five genres were asked to respond, *cumbia* was named 27 times, being the most repeated genre, while *champeta* was named 25 times, being the second most mentioned genre. In total, 18 people mentioned both musical genres.

4.3.1.2. Items shared via Whatsapp group

When you are notified that you have been accepted as a member of *La Puntica No Má'*, you are immediately included in a Whatsapp group[18]. In this group the organizers send questions related to the logistics of the activities, give tips for the realization of the costume, people share material related to the carnival and in general it is a space where people can interact with other members of the *comparsa*. The amount of material shared by this group was extensive, including that related to music. Therefore, for the following task it was decided to sample 20 music-related items shared in this Whatsapp group: 10 consecutive items at a time before the carnival and 10 consecutive items at a time after the carnival.

The information of these elements was included in two tables, one for each moment, with specific information such as the date on which the element was shared, the description of the element, the type of music found in said element, observations, the link to the element and an identification number given for later consultation. At the same time, a graph was made showing the percentage of the type of music that was shared. It should be noted that "African music" includes all music from Africa regardless of genre, for example AfroBeat or *soukus*; "Afro-Caribbean in English" includes musical genres such as reggae, calypso, spouge or parang; "Latin Afro-Caribbean" includes musical genres such as Latin AfroBeat or *reggaeton*; "Traditional ensemble music" includes genres such as *cumbia* or *bullerengue*; and "Other" includes genres such as flamenco rumba, funk, Brazilian funk and electronic

[18] Digital social network for instant messaging.

music. Tropical music" includes all genres sung in Spanish in big-band format, with the exception of "Salsa", which was a category in its own right.

Perhaps one of the most important entries in these lists is the appearance of Wganda Kenya, a musical group that had a very important role in the musical direction that *La Puntica No Má'* wanted to deliver to its members and public in 2023.

#	Shared item	Description
A1	Playlist "Caribe Mega Mix"	A playlist with only music in *champeta* rhythm.
A2	Advertising with song "Sailor Moon" by Yuranis Leon	12 likes - Posting reshared on 13.01.2023 by the same user. | Vivianne La Primera (Vivianne Saler Waldman), captain of this year's *comparsa*, invited to a dance course called "Bailoteo Prende caderas con Alberto Barrios" [Dance to activate your hips with Alberto Barrios] for those who were in Bogota and felt they did not have the skills to move. The message was accompanied by a link on the social network Instagram, where the information was complemented with background music.
A3	Song "Báilalo Como Es" by Chelito De Castro, Mr. Black and Chatella	1 like / Posting was reshared the same day by another user. | Each year, the Queen of the Carnival of Barranquilla presents the song that represents her musically and is known as "La canción de la Reina" (The Queen's Song). This particular song is a combination of music with traditional instruments, tropical orchestra and *champeta*.
A4	Playlist "Aquíiiii… suenaaaa"	2 likes - This playlist was made by Don Alirio, a very famous and admired collector of *La Puntica No Má'*.
A5	Song "Juliette" ("El Parte Cola") by Liberty Tianjama	A song to the rhythm of soukous. Interesting to see that the song has an alternative name in Spanish. This is something common among certain inhabitants of the Colombian Caribbean who take this music and give it a Spanish name for better remembrance.
A6	Playlist "Cañonazos Picoteros"	"From the *champeta* underground in Barranquilla comes Dj Rata Piano, El Rey de los Guarapos, now called Rancha. Dj Rata Piano has been the king of sampling and perreo for more than 15 years, with his remixes and versions of unparalleled flavor. Here we

		present a selection of his best guarapos19 for all the dancers and music lovers of the fine ear, lovers of true African music and *champeta*." Source: taken from the link.
A7	Album "Wganda Kenya & Kammpala Grupo"	An album in which the Colombian band Wganda Kenya shares its music with Kammpala Grupo.
A8	Song "El Lobo" by Wganda Kenya	"Wganda Kenya was a group created by Discos Fuentes with the intention of developing an Afro-Caribbean sound to give an exotic touch to the label and try to reach the Colombian coastal market."[20] It was the main band of *El jardín de las malicias' verbena* of *La Puntica No Má'* in 2023. Their biggest hit is perhaps "El evangelio", a cover of "L'Evangile", by the Haitian kompa band Shleu Shleu. La Puntica No Má' did a lot of work to revive this proposal. To do so, he convinced Fruko, director of this Wganda Kenya and the band Fruko y sus Tesos -one of the most popular salsa groups in Colombia-, to gather the musicians and play their songs at the night party of the *comparsa*.
A9	Album "Colombia! The golden age of Discos Fuentes: The Powerhouse of Colombian music 1960-1979"	This album is dedicated to the musical work of Discos Fuentes, a record label that recorded many hits of carnival and coastal music in general.
A10	Playlist "Vamos es a llevar PUNTICA"	2 likes - Posting was reshared twice that same day by other users. | Personal playlist of one of the members with more trajectory of the *comparsa*. It is one of the most extensive playlists, perhaps the most extensive that was shared.

Table 5. Ten consecutive items shared in the Whatsapp group at a time before the carnival (See more details in Appendix K1),

The first 10 elements of the first moment (i.e., before the carnival) were shared, were precisely the first fifteen elements that the researcher identified after being included in the Whatsapp group. These items were shared one month before the carnival started, between Wednesday, January 11, 2023 and Tuesday, January 17, 2023, i.e. just one week. The reason why people shared so much material in such a short time was perhaps due to the fact that in that week all the new members were accepted, who joined the old members, and everyone wanted in one way or another to emulate the atmosphere that is experienced in the *comparsa* during the carnivals. From the first period, the organizers used the *comparsa*'s own vocabulary, calling everyone *punteros* and the newcomers *virgenes*. Everyone shares information about parties.

[19] Musical genre related to *champeta* emerged in the year 2019 approximately that is also played in a *pic*ó.
[20] https://vampisoul.bandcamp.com/album/s-t-9

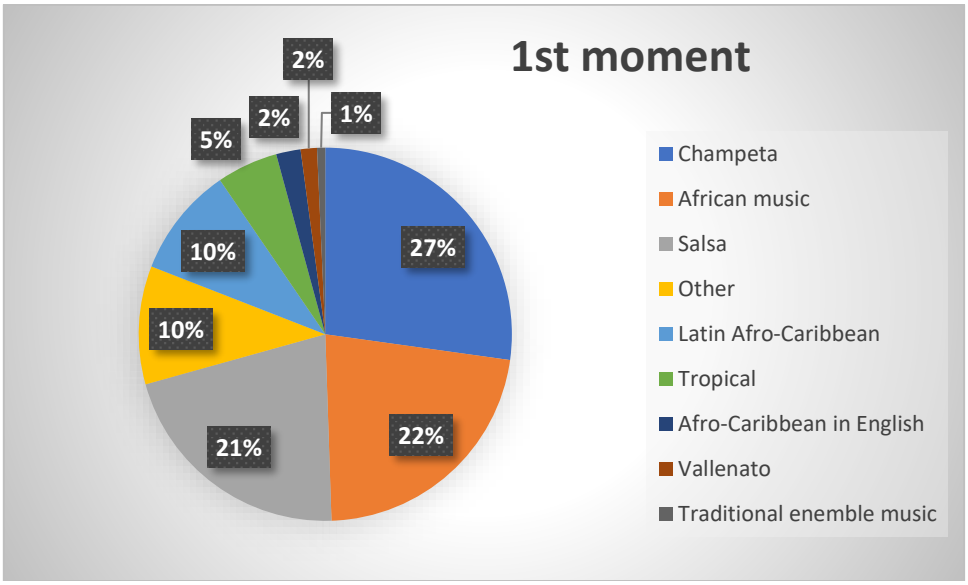


Figure 1. Musical genres related to the 10 elements shared before the carnival in the Whatsapp group of La Puntica No Má'.

The 10 elements of the second moment were shared two months after the first period. In this period there was much less carnival euphoria, therefore, there were fewer posts per day related to music, however, those that appeared are very interesting because it reflects that much of the music listened to before the carnival remains in the members.

#	Shared item	Description
B1	Playlist "This is Wganda Kenya"	Playlist of the main band of the *puntero verbena*.
B2	Song "Amor después del amor" by Fito Paez	Argentinian rock-pop.
B3	Music video "Tamarindo" by Naty Botero	The singer is a member of *La Puntica No Má'* and the video shows what she experienced in the carnival parade of 2023.
B4	Song "Ameyatchi" by Mathei	This song was very viral this year because of a meme.
B5	Song "Oye (Abre tus ojos)" by Sonora Dinamita	*Cumbia* played in a tropical orchestra by a Mexican-Colombian band
B6	Meme with song "Mi primera cana" by Diomédez Díaz	Popular *vallenato* Singer.
B7	Song "Romántica *Champeta*" by Bomba Estéreo, Kevin Florez, The Busy Twist	*Champeta* created by Bomba Stereo. In the video you can see the name of the costume of the singer of the group when she was the captain of the *comparsa*.
B8	Song "Mama" by Joe Arroyo	Popular salsa and latín afro-caribbean Singer.
B9	Song "Candela" by Papá Kumbé	Papá Kumbé is a collective of Electro *Cumbia* and Tropical Bass producers and DJs from the city of Medellín, Colombia.
B10	Song "~ From Deep Sunshine to Earth Beats ~" by KIRA Live Dj SunSet	Electronic music.

Table 5. Ten consecutive items shared in the Whatsapp group at a time after the carnival (See more details in Appendix K2).

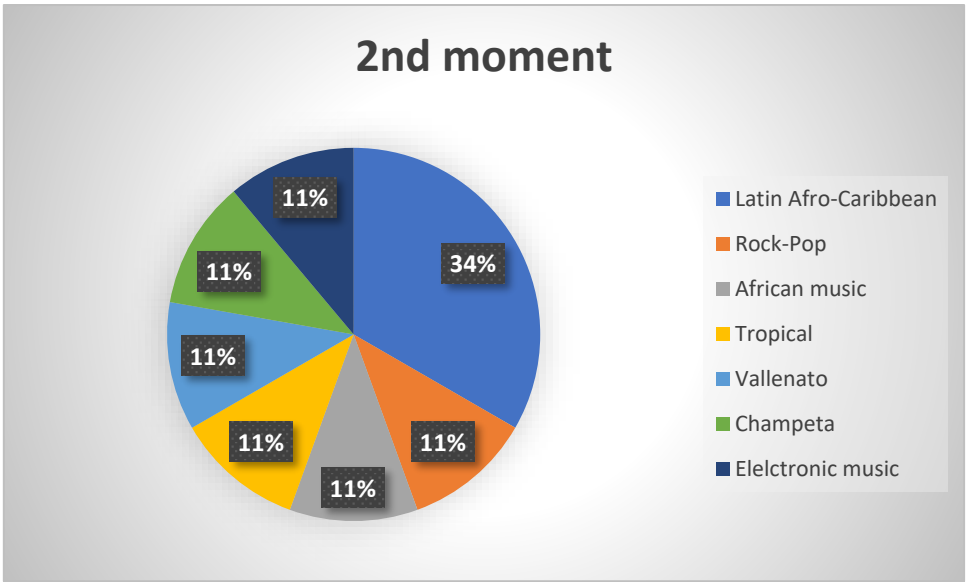


Figure 2. Musical genres related to the 10 elements shared after the carnival in the Whatsapp group of La Puntica No Má'.

4.3.2. Qualitative data

Qualitative data includes interviews, photos and videos, observations and notes.

4.3.2.1. Interviews

Two types of interviews were conducted. Both were semi-structured. The first type was directed to people who have or have had some decision-making power within the *comparsa* and the second was directed to the members of the *comparsa* who paraded. All the interviews have an identification number for consultation, which can be seen in the following tables.

Three of the first interviews were conducted. The three were done after the carnivals; the first two by video call (Zoom), the last one by voice messages through the messaging application Whatsapp. These interviews were as follows:

#	Name	Position	Date of interview
C1	Daniel Angulo	Co-founder of *La Puntica No Má'*	04.04.2023
C2	Orlando Carvajal	General Producer	26.04.2023
C3	Jorge Luis Pinilla (Georghe Pinilla)	Former director of the *comparsa* (2 years)	06.05.2023

Table 6. Interviews to decision-making members of *La Puntica No Má'*.

Of the second interviews, a total of 11 were conducted. All of these interviews were conducted during the different carnival activities during break times.

#	Person	Origin

D1	Man – 30 years old	Bogotan
D2	Man - 35 years old	Bogotan
D3	Man - 55 years old	Colombian (not Caribbean region)
D4	Man - 45 years old	Colombian Caribbean (it doesn't include Barranquilla)
D5	Woman - 35 years old	Barranquillera
D6	Woman - 37 years old	Barranquillera
D7	Woman - 68 years old	Barranquillera
D8	Woman - 56 years old	Colombian (not Caribbean region)
D9	Man - 40 years old	Mexican
D10	Man - 35 years old	US-Citizen
D11	Man - 30 years old	New Zealander

Table 7. Interviews to non-decision-making members of *La Puntica No Má'*.

4.3.2.2. Photos, videos, observations, and notes

During the carnival and the events of the Puntica it was possible to take many photos and videos that helped to understand a little of the context of the party and the *comparsa*. It was also key to remember certain facts that occurred and that have been described in this text. The social networks were of great help since both organizers and members shared content on the networks. At the same time, notes were taken of observations, details, elements and appreciated features of the environment.

Among all the notes that were taken, there were some that were called "memories of conversations" which was basically writing down conversations that the researcher had with people during the carnival, who in some way had been related to the *comparsa*. These conversations were written taking as a reference small notes that were used to recreate these conversations later on. Although in this case, the information may be far from objective, it helped the researcher to remember not only real elements that occurred at that specific moment, but also his own emotions.

5. Discussion

All of the above coincides with the narratives and representations about music in *La Puntica No Má'* exposed above, i.e. there are two main musical axes in the *comparsa*: *cumbia* and *champeta*. The narratives allowed us to understand how both musical genres have been constructed within the *comparsa* and

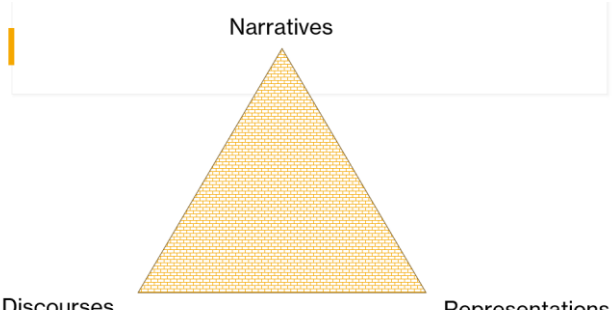


Illustration 3. Triangulation of narratives, representations and discourses.

how they have become part of its identity. The representations allow the *comparsa* (both the organization and its members) to transfer in an artistic way those values and ideologies that the narratives fail to convey by simply communicating them. That is, those elements that are highlighted both in the narratives and in the representations. If we ask ourselves, what are these values and ideologies? The answer would be in the discourses.

Remembering what White said, discourses are systems of rules and conventions that shape the way in which historical narratives are produced and interpreted and where the actor of the discourse highlights certain elements over others, showing a clear position on them in order to influence the position of others regarding a specific topic and that can be proven by observing a multiplication of such discourse through new narratives, a propagation that could also take the form of representations. This opens the door to think that, although the representations do not necessarily explain their ideas explicitly with words, they can do so by highlighting other elements, which can be musical or extra-musical. In other words, in order to identify which are the discourses in *cumbia* and *champeta*, musics that play an important role in the *comparsa*, it would be necessary to make a triangulation between those elements that are most highlighted in the narratives and at the same time that stand out in the representations of these musical genres in *La Puntica No Má'*.

The result of this analysis made it possible to identify three types of discourses, based on the approaches that *comparsa* members may have towards certain musical genres or formats. These discourses coincide with the discourses of authenticity identified by Salge (2020), but unlike him this analysis did not focus on the public and their publications on social networks from the field of image, but rather, on the carnival makers themselves, in this case taking as an example the *comparsa* of *La Puntica No Má'*, in the field of music.

5.1. First discourse: *Cumbia de Chorrera*, as a source of authentic ancestry

The narratives of *La Puntica No Má'* show *cumbia*, specifically the Chorrera variant, and the *millo* format, with its drums, maracas and flutes, as a foundational and fundamental milestone for the *comparsa*. On the one hand, we see how Daniel Angulo, co-founder of the group, advocates the nostalgia and ancestry of *cumbia* for the conception of *La Puntica*. Interviews with members show how they appreciate the presence of *cumbia*, describing it as "the original" or "the most traditional". An American member, approximately 38 years old, who said he has participated in the *comparsa* in many editions, said that *La Puntica No Má'* is only for those who are interested in *cumbia* and traditional music. In the same way, this rhythm has been from the beginning of the *comparsa* a resource for

experimentation and the resulting developments are well received by the leaders and other members under the slogan "Tradition in evolution". A 37-year-old member of the *comparsa* from Barranquilla describes these new proposals as a mix of more globalized music such as funk and electronic music with *cumbia*.

On the other hand, *cumbia* is shown as a genre they call "mother", referring to the fact that *cumbia* is the origin of other musical genres such as *bullerengue* or *mapalé*. For example, Georghe Pinilla, in one part of the interview, he expresses *"cumbia*, obviously *mother cumbia*, [that] is the key to our carnival." Finally, there is the fact that *cumbia* is highlighted for its tri-ethnic origins: African, European and Native American. This is especially evident when they use the word "raizal" to define *cumbia* and *millo*, referring to "something that has different roots or origins" and not to "a person from the islands of San Andres and Providencia" which is how many Colombians understand this term. In the interviews with the members of the *comparsa*, it can be seen how they also attribute certain values, such as "strength" or "tastiness" to the African contribution.

In the same way, the performances of *La Puntica No Má'* show how *cumbia* and the *millo* format stand out within the musical universe. *Cumbia de Chorrera* is seen as the variant that embodies the more traditional side of the *comparsa* and the group Los Originales de Chorrera (in English, The Originals of Chorrera) is present in many events organized by *La Puntica No Má'*. The music of Los Originales de Chorrera has dialogued with musicians associated with the *comparsa* such as Andy Uproot, creating musical proposals that unfold new horizons for the same musical genre. Daniel Angulo, seeing him not as co-founder of the group but rather as a creative musician, presents a repertoire where he fuses electronic resonances with *millo* and *cumbia* sounds and whose texts are related to the *comparsa* and the carnival. This repertoire can be seen in his SoundCloud[21] profile where he has versions of famous *cumbia*s like "El Pescador", but also *cumbia*s composed by him like "La Pollera Arrebata'". What is interesting is that these songs are listed in a playlist that he titles "Kumbias [sic] del Olvido" [*Cumbia*s del olvido], where there are not only *cumbia*s, but also other songs with other musical genres such as "La Quinceañera", which is not a *cumbia* but rather a son de garabato but that many could consider that it fits within the umbrella of *cumbia*, for being a "son" of this musical genre. The lyrics of the songs in this playlist casually highlight the separate instruments and their sounds are associated with certain emotions as when in "La Pollera Arrebata" it says that "el olvido que hay en la *gait*a se posa en tu mirada" [the oblivion in the *gaita* rests on your gaze], referring to the melancholy or sadness that the look of the other person has, and that could be related to the indigenous contribution of the flutes to the musical genre of *cumbia* and to the traditional musical format.

[21] https://soundcloud.com/danielartangulo/popular-tracks

In the texts of the songs in this playlist, words such as "past", “ancestral” and "ritual" can be heard to define *cumbia*, and in the case of "La Quinceañera" it presents the very origins of the *comparsa*, associating these sonorities over and over again with the most autochthonous, the very first and the purest. However, as Juan Sebastián Ochoa (2019) points out, there are no studies or historical and musical analyses that provide evidence that these types of ensembles perform music that represents the most traditional, pioneering or "ancestral" of *cumbia*. Moreover, it is not clear to determine the origin of the term "*cumbia*" because in the middle of the twentieth century, any musical genre of Caribbean coastal origin was stated as *cumbia* (J.S. Ochoa 2019). J.S. Ochoa states:

> “*Cumbia*", like any other concept, is a social construction. In this sense, it is not an ontological entity to be discovered, but rather a human creation that is in permanent transformation and negotiation (2016 : 2).

The above has made music researchers reevaluate the way this musical genre has been treated with all kinds of honors without the historical-musical rigor it deserves, and with it, lay the groundwork for future critical analysis of this rhythm or concept, as J.S. Ochoa (2016) calls it. Among them is a series of four premises about *cumbia* elaborated by Federico Ochoa that is:

1. *Cumbia* is recognized as one of the most important musical practices in Latin America.
2. Colombia is the country of origin of this expression, which later spread, changed and adapted in different countries of the continent.
3. Among musicians, it is recognized that the *conjunto de caña de millo* is the original format of this genre in Colombia.
4. Its epicenter is Barranquilla and its surroundings. (F. Ochoa 2019: 69)

From these premises has been developed precisely one of the imaginaries that we will deal with later, which is that there is a "primordial" *cumbia* that has been changing and adapting in different contexts. More specifically, this first imaginary relates that from a single original *cumbia* there has been a sort of linear evolution. The second imaginary points out that *cumbia* is the mother rhythm of many other musical genres. The third imaginary refers to its tri-ethnic origin. These three imaginaries actually indicate that *cumbia* and the *millo* format are related to a type of essentialist authenticity discourse, which sees this musical genre as absolute, ancestral, unique and original, and which links it to a strong romantic nationalism with respect to Colombia but also to the Caribbean region.

5.1.1. First imaginary: The origin of everything

This first imaginary suggests that there is a single musical root of *cumbia* and that there has been a clear evolution over the years. This evolution has been manifested mainly by an organological

transformation that began with the *millo* flutes, coinciding with one of Federico Ochoa's (2019) premises and continues to evolve. Juan Sebastián Ochoa (2019) explains that this imaginary has been replicated not only by common people but also by intellectuals such as Jorge Nieves (2008), making use of statements that seem absolute, but which have not been made an effort to review in more depth. His critique is presented above all regarding the belief that the different formats have received the *cumbia* inheritance from the previous type of group without even evaluating the degree of influence they may have had from other musical genres to call them also *cumbia*.

The linear evolution according to J.S. Ochoa (2019) begins before 1900 with the *millos* and *gaitas*[22] ensembles and develops until today with different formats such as wind bands and big bands (See Appendix L). Juan Sebastián Ochoa (2019) states that this eagerness to emphasize that there is an original format generates uncertainty, not that much because it is questioned whether or not these instruments were really the first instruments that played *cumbia*, but because it seems that at all costs the most important thing is that these instruments are easily exoticized (and fetishized[23]), and that is a second criticism that is made to this imaginary.

The exoticization is given as a way to emphasize again and again that this genre represents a specific society. A genre that was born from the exchange with many ethnic groups but that especially received in *cumbia*, elements that could not be present in any other society since "the ancestral, the mythical and its timeless past" that are represented in the *millos* (and in the *gait*as) is the pure expression of the indigenous peoples that were here since pre-colonial times. The interesting thing here is that these peoples did not migrate for historical reasons as the Spaniards or the enslaved blacks from Africa might have done. So they are instruments of a community that can be marked on a map and that today is called the Colombian Caribbean, which, despite being part of a sovereign state that is Colombia, is presented as a region with great autonomy in the field of culture.

The above reminds us a little of the concept of "imagined communities". According to Anderson (1983/1991), communities are imagined and to make this claim he considers the different political constituencies he investigated, such as countries, dynasties and people who feel part of a specific religion. Anderson argues that the nation is an imagined political community, which is limited, because

[22] The *gaitas* are wind instruments of indigenous origin, made of wood, pitch and an embouchure made with the feather of a duck, although today they are also made of plastic. There are variations of this instrument: the female *gaita*, which plays the melody and has five holes, and the male *gaita*, which has two holes and accompanies the melody of its female counterpart.

[23] Since these instruments, which have a leading and dominant role in music, are always played by men. These instruments are perceived as "feminine" and when played by men, the instrument is objectified, creating a pattern of domination of the masculine towards the feminine (F. Ochoa 2019). The above has changed lately and it is increasingly common to see women playing *gait*as and *millo* flutes. An important example is Mayté Montero, who is one of the most important female *gait*a players today (https://www.sic.gov.co/ruta-pi/septiembre2020/mayte-montero-y-su-legado-en-el-d%C3%ADa-internacional-de-la-musica).

it has finite boundaries, beyond which lie other nations, and sovereign, because it destroyed the legitimacy of the divinely ordained hierarchical dynastic kingdom to achieve freedom. It is imagined as a community because it is always conceived as a deep and horizontal camaraderie. At the same time, there was a conception of coincident temporality in which cosmology and history were indistinguishable and created the idea that the origins of the world and of the men of a supposed nation are essentially identical. In this way the instruments are reified in an exotic way to reaffirm imagined communities: the Colombian Caribbean at first and the Colombian nation later on.

A third criticism of this imaginary is given by the simple concept of evolution, which of course is linked to the Darwinian conception of biological evolution. This theory brought about many debates, mainly because of the omission of the word genes, but also because of the non-use of the term "unidirectional progress". Using these terms in a cultural field such as the one we present in this case may not conform to the reality of the way in which complexity manifests itself in cultural processes, which is not at all unidirectional. Maintaining the term "progression" meant being the target of much criticism because it allowed the adoption and legitimization of ideologies of Western superiority that justified the oppression of the weak by the powerful as part of a system that gives survival to those who can adapt better (Hofstadter 1955; Laland, et al. 2014; Stocking 1982). Thus, to think that a wind band is more evolved than a traditional format and that a big-band is more advanced than a wind band because of a "natural development" is problematic, especially if one takes into account that the instruments that represent the "primordial" ensemble are indigenous flutes, while the formats seen below are composed of instruments more associated with Western organology.

As mentioned above, in the case of *La Puntica No Má'*, the *cumbia* performed is *cumbia de Chorrera*. It is striking that when speaking with Orlando Carvajal, he seems to emphasize the originality of *cumbia de Chorrera*, playing with the very name of the Chorrera band (Cumbia Original de Chorrera) with which La Puntica works year after year:

> [...] Chorrera is a municipality and there is a *cumbia* that is original from there called the original *cumbia de Chorrera*. It is a *cumbia* movement. I mean, like saying *cumbia cienaguera*[24], well, there is a *cumbia* called the original *cumbia de Chorrera*, which is a particular type of *cumbia*. Well, the band that plays with us from Chorrera is called the “Cumbia Original de Chorrera”. [Carvajal 2023]

It is also worth quoting Geohrge Pinilla Acevedo as he highlights the role of the instruments of Chorrera *cumbia* and their relationship with ancestry. In this case, he shows one of the most repeated comments

[24] Cienaguera means “from Ciénaga”, another place in the Caribbean region of Colombia.

within *La Puntica No Má'* that turns the idea that this progress is positive to affirm that *cumbia*, as it is presented in the *comparsa*, is there to remember the essence of the origins:

> That is why [the band of] Chorrera is always there with its flute, with its drums, because we cannot forget that we are in carnival and carnival is drum, is percussion, live music in the street, is to feel the hot pavement and go out to jump and get your feet burned to the rhythm of the drum. That is our essence and we want to keep that so that it does not become something completely modern, so to speak, because modernity has passed. Now we are post-modern so that the roots keep feeding us all the time. I think that the drum moves the blood because the drum comes from Africa and it moves us all the time. A party where there is no drum, where there is no percussion, is not a party for us. Especially during carnival. After carnival we can make a different relationship, but in carnival the beat of the leather is necessary and indispensable for the enjoyment. (Pinilla Acevedo 2023)

From the perspective of globalization, this narrative always seems to bring us back to the origins, to a moment in which the first foundations and musical instruments of what is a young nation, such as Colombia and the Colombian Caribbean, were laid by the ethnicities that participated in its conformation. Any trace of technological development on them has no place in this narrative.

5.1.2. Second imaginary: Mother of musical genres

This imaginary suggests that *cumbia* is a musical genre that is the basis for all others that exist in the Colombian Caribbean region. In this way, *cumbia* represents the strengthening of its own identity reflected in rhythms that are associated with different geographical, economic, political and cultural contexts of the Caribbean. Some of these genres are *tambora*, *son de garabato* and *porro* (See Appendix M).

This imaginary can be seen in audio-documentaries such as *40 años de música costeña - la historia de la cumbia colombiana* [40 years of coastal music - the history of Colombian *cumbia*], where the authors express:

> *Cumbia*, as it grew stronger, became a mother rhythm from which the different manifestations of the Coast later emerged. Thus were born *bullerengue, porro, puya*, *merengue*, *fandango* and other rhythms. (Apuleyo & Forero 1967 : min. 2:00)

J.S. Ochoa (2019) explains that even though these other genres have musical coincidences in terms of their rhythmic base and organology, it is impossible to know today whether all the other rhythms were

generated from *cumbia*, especially if one considers that until 1960 it was not clear whether *cumbia* was a genre, a rhythmic pattern, a dance, or all of the above. F. Ochoa (2019) explains that until well into the middle of the twentieth century it was *porro* and not *cumbia* the genre that stood out in dance halls and in the recordings of prominent orchestras, such as that of Lucho Bermúdez, which used to specify the musical genre of each song. In fact, before that time practically any *Costeño* music was called *cumbia, porro* or *aires costeños* regardless of whether the rhythm was different. If *porro* was the most mentioned genre at that time, even more than *cumbia*, it is not implausible to think that perhaps *cumbia* originated from *porro*, or rather that *porro*, as well as many other musical genres, had their independent development, in spite of the musical coincidences with *cumbia*. This is interesting, if one takes into account that many of these musical genres are based in specific geographical contexts, for example, *porro* and *fandangos* in the savannahs of Córdoba and Sucre, and *paseo, merengue, son* and *puya* in the Guajira desert and in the lands of the Department of Magdalena and, above all, the Department of Cesar.

Now, there are also the multiple *cumbias* that have appeared in Latin America in countries such as Ecuador, Chile, Mexico, Argentina, Peru and Venezuela (Parra 2019). It is quite accepted within academia-for example, in the premises of Federico Ochoa (2019)-that *cumbia* is recognized as one of the most important musical practices in Latin America due to its adoption and adaptation throughout the continent. For obvious reasons, this would make Colombian *cumbia* the mother genre of all *cumbia*s that emerged from Mexico to Argentina.

Taking into account this idea of multiplicity of genres and geographical contexts that are related to the same genre called *cumbia*, it is necessary to talk about the notion of glocalization, which refers to the practices of adoption and adaptation of socio-cultural, political and economic elements taking into account the interconnection and communication between different geographical and cultural contexts and which is possible today thanks to the advances of globalization. In this way, phenomena such as enculturalization[25], interculturalization[26] and transculturalization[27] can occur. (Pennycook & Mitchell 2009; Hemetek, Kölb, Mayrlechner & Sağlam 2015). For example, in Peru we see how *cumbia*, on the one hand, adopted the rhythm with sounds of the *hayno*, typical of the indigenous people of the Andes of certain areas of that country, generating its own identity that told the stories and experiences of the Andean indigenous migration in the capital Lima, and on the other hand, it created its own identity in the Peruvian Amazon, by merging this rhythm with electronic sounds and those who command these

[25] Process that tends to integrate the individual to the group, society and culture of belonging, in this case, to a family/community culture and to a school culture.
[26] Presence and equitable interaction of diverse cultures and the possibility of generating shared cultural expressions through dialogue and mutual respect.
[27] Phenomenon that occurs when a social group receives and adopts the cultural forms that come from another group.

groups were young women and is associated with sensuality and adolescent fun (Quispe Lázaro 2019). This example could be considered a case of transculturation.

Defining cumbia as "mother" or as Geohrge Pinilla (2023) describes it "mother *cumbia*" is part of a narrative that has the need to classify, then protect and legitimize its value in the context of Carnival. This narrative, therefore, is related from the perspective of globalization to narratives proper to folklore, heritage and institutional studies. Reading the texts related to these narratives, it can be seen very clearly how *cumbia* is highlighted as having a central role as "mother of rhythms" or "mother of dances" and it could not be found in any source that porro has at some point taken its place, as F. Ochoa (2019) suggests it could have happened. In the same way, neither could it be read in any document that the *cumbia de Chorrera*, which is the one taken as a reference within *La Puntica No Má'*, has been the creative variant of other genres inside or outside the *comparsa*.

5.1.3. Third imaginary: Manifestation of a tri-ethnic racial mixture

The last imaginary refers to the mixed origin of *cumbia*. Juan Sebastián Ochoa (2019) explains that in the twentieth century a dispute was generated about the ethnic origin of *cumbia*. On the one hand, personalities such as musicians José Barros and Pacho Galán argued that the indigenous root was what allowed the creation of the musical genre, while others such as anthropologist and physician Manuel Zapata Olivella, folklorist Guillermo Abadía and musicians Efraín Medina and Lucho Bermúdez pointed out that it was an imminently black musical genre. This led to ideological discussions that can be considered racist and not supported by empirical evidence. for example, it was said that the indigenous origin was paramount because *cumbia* at that time was seen as "measured, demure and wise, far from the eroticism and freneticism associated with the black people" (J.S. Ochoa 2019 : 39-40), while the opposite side thought that everything that could be "exoticized" should be considered as a sample of the cultural legacy of the African diaspora in the country.

It was not until the arrival of the article "C*umbia*: musical synthesis of the Colombian nation" by folklorist, dancer and pedagogue Delia Zapata, sister of Manuel Zapata, that a new position on its origin appeared. In the text she points out:

> The proof of the origin of *cumbia* is linked to the integration of the American cocktail and goes back to the roots of our tri-ethnic ancestor, whose three ingredients, already mixed in different proportions, form the synthesis of the Colombian Nation. [...]
>
> The proper twang of the instruments that accompany with their music, the choreography of *cumbia* shows it: drums of black accent; flutes of indigenous groan, the dress and the singing reveal the Hispanic style. [...]

> A team or choreographic ensemble in which the rhythmic euphoria of the black people, the melancholy cadence of the Indian and the gracefulness of the Spaniard converge. It is like a musical synthesis of our nationality (Zapata 1962 : 190-200).

Mariano Candela (2003), Ana María Tamayo (2013), Juan Sebastián Ochoa (2016) and Federico Ochoa (2014) explain that this sentence is presented as a more political than historical solution that helps to create an idea of *cumbia* that clings to positive images or emotions of each ethnic component, which J.S. Ochoa (2019) reinterprets as: the joy of the black, the sobriety of the indigenous and the elegance and haughtiness of the European. He also explained that this proposal represents a process of whitening by the dominant classes, who preferred *cumbia* for being a dance seen as calm, measured, demure, controlled, haughty and elegant, perfect for the symbolization of a civilized Colombia, as opposed to other dances such as *fandango*, *mapalé* or *puya* seen as disorderly, erotic and wild. In other words, for J.S. Ochoa, the black and indigenous components were a function of the European element, thus reminding us of images of the colony where the Europeans were supported by the blacks and Indians, as well as their resources (See Appendix N).

Today it can be said that the discussion on the origin of *cumbia* is over, since the adoption of Delia Zapata's proposal is generalized in all kinds of articles in private media and official sources (Carbó 2006; Juáregui 2023). The researcher Carlos Miñana pointed out that by being very "idealized, embalmed and consecrated by the authority of folklorists[, the questioning of this cultural project may] hurt popular sensitivity, that is, deny the identity, the roots, the 'proper' values of Colombian culture. It is to be a stateless person who -in certain contexts- deserves to be lynched, or at least excluded" (1999: 36). As J.S. Ochoa (2019) indicates in this type of cases it is more difficult to deconstruct than to construct the myth about *cumbia* because of the symbolic power that it carries and that prevents contradicting cultural institutions, which are the reflection of the image of a society that perceives itself as mestizo, and that protects them under the pretext of being necessary for the structuring and consolidation of a country in full development as a nation.

5.2. Second discourse: *Champeta*, as an experiment in authentic expansion

The narratives of *champeta* within the *comparsa* are diverse. Interestingly, among the *comparsa* members who were interviewed, *champeta* is highlighted as an enlivener of the environment, describing it as an entertaining, sexual, uninhibiting and even hipster genre. It could also be observed that the positive valuation of *champeta* stands out especially among the newer members, something that contrasts with those who have been members for more years. It is interesting to see how *champeta* is often referred to in many different ways without any distinction: *champeta africana*, *champeta*

criolla, *terapia*[28]. Finally, in some interviews there was some concern about the possible overshadowing of *cumbia* by *champeta*. Some people diverged in the type of music they listened to, for example, the same song was sometimes described as *champeta*, sometimes as Afro-Caribbean. In the representations they show that *champeta* is very popular.

The representations of *champeta* are quite visible. On the one hand we see that *cumbia* shares much of the *comparsa's* performances with what for many is called *champeta*. "Qué bonito", the Bomba Estéreo song that for some *punteros* is considered a milestone for *La Puntica No Má'*, is precisely a champeta. The song mentions the *comparsa* and is played continuously in the concerts organized by the *comparsa*. “Carnavalera”, the song by Bomba Estéreo and Systema Solar, also considered a milestone for the *comparsa*, has musical elements that could relate it to the *champeta*. The *comparsa* regularly invites to its events *picoteros*, whose main music is *champeta*. Wganda Kenya, the guest band at the 2023 *verbena*, is known for performing songs that for some could be considered *champeta*.

It is said that the origin of the picós takes place in the 40's in the popular neighborhoods of the working class (i.e. the lower strata) of Cartagena de Indias where they rented phonographs to listen and dance with families and neighbors. In the 1950s these gatherings began to take place in spaces or dancehalls called casetas (K-Zs), where there was a charge for entry and for the alcoholic beverages sold, which they began to call *picó* (Birenbaum Quintero 2018). Competition among the *picotero*s, that is, the owners of the *picós*[29], was increasing, so they were very concerned about having the largest and loudest system of amplifiers and speakers, but also about having repertoires that would attract more customers. It is said that, in the beginning, what was played in the *picós* were mainly rural Colombian musical practices that included *cumbia*s, *bullerengue*s and *gaitas*, as well as Cuban *son* music, learned from Cuban engineers supervising the region`s sugar plantations in the 1920s (Minski, Ríos & Samper 2006). This forced the *picoteros* to interact with sailors who could help them obtain music and whom they called corresponsales or "correspondents".

In the 70's picoteros discovered that the fanaticism of the customers could depend on a song that could only be heard in a specific *pic*ó. These songs were called "exclusives" and their discovery depended on the co-managers who had to look for records that were not easily identifiable by other *picó*. Consequently, *picoteros* paid large sums of money for singular copies, or even for as many copies as could be obtained, in order that another *pic*ó would not have them (Birenbaum Quintero 2018). This competition brought about a change in repertoire, due to the fact that the correspondents were

[28] In English, therapy.

[29] *Picoteros* are mainly the owners of the *picós*. However, all those who are part of the *picó* production chain could also be called *picoteros*, i.e. the producers, the singers, the instrumentalists, the distributors, the listeners and the repertoire, the sound system and the related graphic art.

looking for music never heard in the *picós*, which always had as a main characteristic, to be African or related to the African diaspora. Thus, other Afro-Caribbean music began to be brought in, such as *Jíbara* music from Puerto Rico, *kompá* from Haiti, *zouk* from the French Antilles of Guadeloupe and Martinique, *ragga* from Panama, samba from Brazil, socca from Trinidad and Jamaican reggae, and with time, more distant music from West and South Africa began to arrive, such as Congolese *soukous* and *mbqnga* from South Africa. Eventually these musics as a whole began to be called *champeta*, although today this repertoire of foreign exclusives is also called *champeta africana* or *terapia africana*.

The development of a repertoire selected on the basis of its exclusivity began to acquire a certain aesthetic value that can be identified in a series of elements that are not only sonorous, such as the use of certain synthesizers or drum pads (such as the Casio Sk-5 keyboard or the Yamaha DD series) or the appearance of the "espeluque" or "placas"[30] to accompany these musics, but also visual and dancistic, as ways of dancing began to be created. It was not until 1992 when a young *picotero* named Yamiro Marín, who could not get more exclusive, began to create his own proposals, sung in Spanish by local artists with African music tracks (or African *champetas*) as background music. Music with these characteristics was called "*champeta criolla*" or "*terapia criolla*". This shift of imported recordings to local production did not mean a loss for the *picoteros* with respect to the "uniqueness" that the exclusives represented, but rather allowed through the informal sale of copies or their reproduction on radio stations more and more people to get to know this music that generally continued to find affinity in guitar-led formats of Congolese soukous and, occasionally, South African mbaqanga (Birenbaum Quintero 2018) which attracted more people to the culture of *picó*. Technological developments have meant that the sonority of *champeta criolla* has expanded and acquired new sonorities sometimes more electronic, sometimes highlighting its African origins. Today we speak of urban *champeta*, which is influenced by other musical genres such as hip hop and reggaeton and is very popular in the cities (Gómez Gómez 2022).

Therefore, it is understandable that for many people within the *comparsa* it is difficult to define what *champeta* is, because basically certain sounds from West or South Africa, even if they are not sung in Spanish, can be considered *champeta*s. In this way songs like "Qué bonito" and "Carnavalera", or the music of Wganda Kenya can be understood as *champeta*s, although of course, this statement can generate debate. What is certain is that the *champeta* has a place in the *comparsa* and its members have a series of imaginaries that are part of the discourse that underlies this genre within the *comparsa*. These imaginaries, however, coincide with a rather constructivist type of discourse on authenticity,

[30] Recorded voice announcements, advertisements and boasts.

which values the process of constant creation and recreation that is not static and that changes over the years.

5.2.1. First imaginary: The future of Colombian sound system movement

Champeta is revolutionizing the music scene, specifically the one related to the sound system movement. Its appearance in various cultural contexts shows that it is increasingly appreciated and enjoyed in spaces such as parties, parades or carnival festivals in Barranquilla. It is precisely in the *verbena*s such as those organized by *La Puntica* that *champeta* acquires a leading role since in these spaces there will always be a sound system or *pic*ó for its reproduction. And it is in these spaces where the *punteros* have seen the musical expansion that the genre has achieved. In the text "Permutación de la música de *verbena*: nuevas sonoridades. Caso Systema Solar" (2017), Piñeres and Vega Casanova explain how *verbena* music, including *champeta*, presents new sonorities because of a cultural hybridization that has been based on new processes of technological mediation and cultural appropriation.

To begin with, Piñeres and Vega Casanova (2017) explain how technology has been key to the reinvention of *verbena* music, starting with the incorporation of equipment and new production techniques such as remixing songs. While this is not specific to *champeta*, in *verbena*s it takes on a crucial role because the *picoteros* constantly test the type of equipment they use in the hope of convincing a willing audience to judge the artist's new feats. Cardona, Muñoz, Álvarez and Velázquez (2014) express that the human-tool interaction becomes so close that the mediating role of the tool models both in the listeners' perceptions and in the performers' actions. Menin & Schiavio define technological mediation from a musical point of view as to "the relationship between intentions and desires on the part of musicians and the technology that generates the music" (2013 : 810). In other words, technology serves as a mediator because it permanently allows the performer to evaluate himself if he feels comfortable with the musical results obtained and the response of his audience.

To explain mediation by cultural appropriation, Piñeres and Vega Casanova refer to Subercaseaux (1988) who establishes that this concept is associated with the idea of dependence and exogenous domination, which points to a fertility and a creative process through which foreign elements become "own" or "appropriate". For Piñeres and Vega Casanova, adaptations and transformations based on a code initially different from their own become relevant because they imply construction dynamics that can be musically valued as authentic if they are used in consonance with technological mediation. To fully understand their point of view, let us understand that this study starts from the premise that these new musics have had resistance to hegemonic sound manifestations that already sounded in the carnival *verbena*s of Barranquilla and that, if it were not for these mediation processes added to an

environment self-defined as "independent" that allows certain creative freedom, their affinity would not have been achieved.

*Champeta*s within the *verbena*s appeared much later than other genres such as traditional folkloric music, salsa or *vallenato*. As Piñeres and Vega Casanova's text indicates, *verbena* music arrived even later in the upper middle and upper strata, that is, where most of the members of *La Puntica No Má'* live, as shown in the surveys carried out in this work. *La Puntica* could be considered an "independent" space, so it is only natural that these musics flourish in *verbena*s organized by this *comparsa*.

Now, let's keep in mind that Systema Solar, the band that Piñeres and Vega Casanova's text exemplifies as a case, is precisely one of the bands that *La Puntica* takes as a reference for one of its songs ("Carnavalera").It is worth noting that, in this article, the musicians themselves do not define their music as *champeta* but rather as *berbeneutika* and argue that this music is based on Caribbean and African music, where *champeta* itself is included, but its hybridization is generated with the contact of electronic music such as house and techno. The term berbeneutika takes its name from the *verbena*s but especially from a *verbena* party called "La Berbetrónika" which is still celebrated in Barranquilla and where AfroBeat and music that it's called today as *champetas criollas* [creole *champetas*] and *champetas africanas* [African *champetas*] also flourish and still serve today as inspiration for the creation of new *champetas criollas*. This party fulfills the same conditions that the Puntica has, that is to say, a celebration where people of the upper and upper middle classes participate, willing to listen to new sonorities given its "independent" character.

It is interesting to see that among the genres mentioned by the members of *La Puntica*, neither house music, nor techno, much less *berbeneutika* were ever present, but there was a lot of talk about the "*champeta*s that Systema Solar makes". Perhaps, when the members of *La Puntica* indicate that the future of the Colombian sound system movement is given thanks to the *champeta*, in reality what they mean is that the singularity or authenticity of this process that is being developed is explained by this type of sonorities that are being created thanks to a process of permutation that is found in contexts similar to those of *La Puntica*. As explained above, the *champeta* was already danced in *verbena*s, but only and exclusively in the *verbena*s of the popular neighborhoods of Barranquilla, but thanks to this cultural hybridization, today it is allowed to be valued and recognized in a great part of the population, breaking the barriers of social classes and reinventing itself as a musical manifestation.

5.2.2. Second imaginary: Displacement of former genres

Given the high popularity of *champeta* in the new generations, both founding members and new members somehow expressed that *champeta* could make disappear or take away importance to carnival music genres that have always accompanied this *comparsa*, including *cumbia* itself. The concern is based on how *champeta* has been appearing in all carnival spaces in a fast and strong way,

especially thanks to the new digital spaces brought by this new period of globalization, which in this work we call "integration".

An example can be the so-called *Canción del Carnaval* [Carnival Song], which as previously mentioned is a song that becomes very popular during carnival and was not declared as such by any carnival entity, broadcaster or public institution. In a list that can be seen in the Wikipedia page you can see how already in the two thousand *champeta* begins to have prominence and since then several carnival songs are cataloged in this genre. The first *champeta* was "El ñato mama ron" by Noel Petro in 2009 and up to the year 2023 another 10 *champeta*s can be counted in this list of carnival songs (See Appendix P).

Another example is the Carnival Queen's songs, which are those videos that each year the Carnival queens release to present themselves to the Carnival public. These videos show the versatility of the queen who shows that she can dance different types of musical genres, so each song is composed of fragments in different musical styles. The first song of the queen was published in 2010 and only until 2016 a *champeta* can be heard in the song "Una sola gozadera" by Manuel Ariza, Lisandro Polo and Twister El Rey is heard being Marcela García Caballero the queen of the carnival. Since then, all the songs of the queens have *champeta* fragments in their videos (See Appendix Q).

This concern for losing traditions is addressed by Edgar Rey Sinning in his text "Joselito Carnaval" (1992) who blames it directly on the development of capitalism in the city. According to him, there are elements of the carnival such as the salvoconduct, the conquest, the assaults and the piñatas that have disappeared or have been modified due to the economic relations that are built in the city and that are dominated by the ruling elites. When exploring the texts related to carnival it can be observed that in the field of music we see that each generation has had some new musical genre that has "put at risk" other musical genres, however, all have been welcomed and included within the catalog of carnival music, with the exception of certain European and North American airs that were driven by the elites and that made passage through the carnival[31] (Solano & Bassi 2016). The above may occur because with the development of carnival new *comparsas* or commercial establishments appear that appropriate the new genres or these new sounds begin to be recognized in the Orchestra Festival by creating new categories. This has happened with other genres such as salsa (Stevenson Samper 2018), merengue (Segebre, et al. 2017) and *vallenato* (Bassi & Solano 2017) in the second half of the 20th century and reggaeton from the 2000s (Villamizar Morgado 2023).

It has also happened that future generations rescue traditions and musical genres of the past and appropriate them, being these clear cases of musical revival. Such is the case of the costume of the *capuchones* or the *letanías*, which today have come back to life and which were traditions mentioned

[31] Mainly waltzes and foxtrots.

by Rey Sinning's text (1992) that he described as extinct. In the field of music we see for example the case of the *son de garabato* (Oviedo 2019; Burgos 2019). *Garabato* is a dance that is presumed to be original from the enslaved blacks and now is considered one of the most traditional and popular dances of the Barranquilla's Carnival. The *son de garabato* is the music that currently accompanies this dance, although it seems that it was originally performed with the rhythm of *chandé* with which it has rhythmic similarities (Oviedo 2019).

It seems that the rescue of the dance, costumes and music is due to the elites of the city who appropriated and stylized it according to their aesthetic parameters. We see then that its music in traditional format (López & Martínez 2015) is enjoyed in the same way as it is done with its later modernization that adjusted to the global trends of the moment to the point of modifying the rhythmic pattern from *chandé* to the currently performed *son de garabato* (See Appendix R) and adopting the big band format in order to be performed in the ballrooms of private clubs, which made it for some time associated with the upper classes of the city (Amórtegui 2018; Oviedo 2019). It is precisely a doodle son called "Te olvidé", the song valued as the "anthem of the carnival" and it is curious to see that in turn it was considered "song of the carnival" in the year 2021, a year in which the carnival was not celebrated in person due to the Coronavirus pandemic.

The above may coincide with the term *elitelore* coined by Friedemann (1985) who explains that in the Barranquilla Carnival it is possible to point out that there are festive expressions that are identified with belonging to a certain social class and that the representatives of the *elitelore* (the elite) share that moment simultaneously with the folklore of the masses and may even participate in it. According to her, "the *elitelore* is defined as the knowledge, the social mythology, the particularities in aspects such as the costume, the places frequented, the car, etc. of the group whose situation at the top of the social pyramid allows it to accentuate its objectives in the tasks of power management in different fields" (1985 : 16). This would indicate that certain cultural elements and dynamics related to the taste of the elites could be diffused to the lower classes as a function of their power and this would give the representatives of the *elitelore* the peace of mind to enjoy both worlds, however, it is not reciprocal.

Based on the above, the *son de garabato* could never be considered as *elitelore* because it is not a manifestation that originally came from the upper classes, as were the waltz and the foxtrot, which were always kept within the walls of private social clubs. Rather the *son de garabato* would be considered as a resource of the folklore of the masses that was appropriated and could have all the cultural apparatus in its favor due to the economic, political and social resources of the most influential classes, but this never meant to overshadow other musical genres of the carnival.

The same could happen with *champeta*. One could consider the music of Wganda Kenya as a manifestation of *champeta* and its "rebirth" as the fruit of the efforts of a *comparsa* like *La Puntica* No Má', which may be related to the elites. Under Friedemann's parameters, this could be considered as the appropriation of a folk music, but never a manifestation of elitelore. Wganda Kenya's music was never forgotten within the context of carnival, however, it did take on a new impulse and meaning within a *comparsa*, which sees in the past its source of inspiration to consolidate a creative future as it is a musical genre that actively plays with the processes of globalization and its possibilities thanks to technology. The latter never meant to displace other genres such as *cumbia*, in fact, more than 20 years have passed since the first social networks were created and this has not happened, it has only been strengthened to the same level as other carnival music genres already consolidated. In any case, *champeta* has never been interested in displacing other genres either because in essence its industry has always remained parallel to the mainstream and therefore never received influences from popular genres among the masses of society such as *vallenato* (Birenbaum Quintero 2018). Perhaps, alternating this genre with the others performed in this *comparsa* was the way in which these sonorities naturally adjusted to the context of *La Puntica.*

It could be argued that experience has shown that the musical manifestations that originally came from the elites were doomed to disappear, but those that were appropriated have endured or have been revitalized and are strongly felt, however, none has managed to displace any other carnival music genre.

5.2.3. Third imaginary: Between resistance and liberation of the bodies

Always when talking about *champeta* in the Colombian context it is common to find its association with the black identity of the popular neighborhoods of cities like Cartagena or Barranquilla, which have suffered rejection and discrimination by the elites who for a long time did not share their taste for this musical genre. When reviewing texts related to *champeta*, many authors can be found who support this idea based on historical facts of the colonial past, such as the transatlantic slave trade and places like San Basilio de Palenque[32], but also in what this genre means for the black communities of these Colombian Caribbean cities that see in *champeta* the result of resistance struggles and their reencounter with their origins in the African continent (Gómez Gómez 2022). Mosquera and Provansal (2000), as well as Bohórquez (2000) explain that this aversion is mainly due to racial and moral stereotypes that have long prevented the legitimacy of these manifestations.

[32] San Basilio de Palenque is a township of 4200 inhabitants, located in the municipality of Mahates, in the department of Bolívar (Colombia). It was declared Cultural and Intangible Heritage of Humanity for being the first free town in colonial America (so decreed in 1691); a place far from the colonies where African slaves escaped to live in freedom, with autonomy and independence.

This historical exclusion has nevertheless had signs of rebellion and social protest that seek to proclaim independence against the elites by embracing Africanness (Cueto Quintero 2016). In this way language, types of relationships and other cultural manifestations such as *champeta* are elements that on the one hand are seen as tools whose purpose is to protect memory and highlight Afro identities in the Colombian Caribbean, but on the other hand transgress the socioeconomic, political and aesthetic values that another part of society had already cemented (Del Río 2003). Cunin (2003) explains that the way of perceiving these claims as an aggression is typical of the construction of the Afro as the "other", interpreted as the savage, the "non-white", the disorderly, the illegal, the vicious and the "uncivilized". As a consequence, its invisibilization and rejection has been promoted, motivating the historical aversion towards *champeta*.

There are several elements of the *champeta* that may clash with already established customs, such as the informal market product of the exchange typical of the global south that was built (Birenbaum Quintero 2018) and the use of a language defined as "champetúo" (Aldana 2006). However, the *champeta* dance is undoubtedly one of the elements that has presented the most disapproval. Its high erotic and sexual content has been seen as a threat to the hegemonic sectors that have been formed with conservative and traditionalist discourses with the body (Bohórquez 2000).

In the text *Champeta/terapia: más que música y moda, folclor urbanizado del Caribe colombiano* [*Champeta*/*terapia*: more than just music and fashion, urbanized folklore of the Colombian Caribbean] by Contreras Hernández (2003), certain unthinkable resistances identified in the context of this musical genre are discussed. According to him, the *verbenas* and *champetas* are spaces where in some way machismo has experienced erosion. He affirms that with the *champeta* there has been greater autonomy and participation of women, especially in terms of socializing and dancing. He continues his argument by stating that this sexual dance does not necessarily constitute the labeling of women as promiscuous or vulgar, but rather that they have been able to embrace their freedom and can be admired for their dancing skills. In principle, the dance demands a closeness between the couples in which they should be practically embracing, intertwining their legs and touching the pelvis of the dancing partner. Contreras Hernández (2003) defines this basic position as "dance embrace". The same author lists a variety of dance passes that invite one to forget modesty and celebrate the bodies, for example: *el reloj* [the clock], *el cochero* [the coachman], *el policía* [the policeman], *la tijera* [the scissors], *el taxista* [the taxi driver], *la camita* [the little bed], *el escorpión* [the scorpion], *la pulga* [the flea], etc.

This is perhaps the reason why the members of *La Puntica No Má'* see in this rhythm a way to rebel and be uninhibited regardless of the social norms that in Barranquilla and Colombian society may not

be so well received in other contexts. In the interview with Daniel Angulo, he expresses that rebelliousness was a foundational element of the *comparsa*:

> In those early years we classified ourselves as a carnival guerrilla. We did not have a space in the parade. We didn't have a legally written name. We simply snuck into the Battle of Flowers. With our sabrosura dancing among all the *comparsas*. When someone was careless we all got in. And we would start dancing and enjoying ourselves. That was the beginning of our participation in the carnival. It was never something official. We always did it underground. With time it became institutionalized because the carnival closed its gates quite a lot and did not allow us to do this kind of thing. We had to register and go through the whole process like everyone else. However, the dose of rebelliousness and art, which is what differentiates us from other *comparsas*. We always want to be at the forefront of the carnival, but with our coat of arms. (Angulo 2023)

Catalina Ruiz Navarro, journalist, feminist, member of the *comparsa* and who was captain in 2014, writes the following in one of her columns:

> When I was asked to make a playlist for [Mexican magazine] SinEmbargo, without hesitation I thought of making a list with the hits of a genre that for me (and for many) is the most revolutionary contribution of Colombian music to the world in the last thirty years: the *champeta*. *Champeta* is a rhythm that was born in the marginal and black neighborhoods of Cartagena de Indias, our most touristic city in the Caribbean and former slave distribution center for all of Latin America. That is why the whole social, cultural and anthropological scenario of *champeta* has to do with marginalization and resistance [...] The story is archetypal of many genres such as tango and *cumbia*, with which *champeta* also shares the postmodern ways of remix and one or another dilemma about morals, sex, and even copyrights. The phenomenon is fascinating and in Colombia perhaps an introduction is no longer necessary, however, to show this genre to a Mexican and Latin American audience, I would like to take the time to tell you what it is that makes *champeta* generate so much discomfort and so much devotion. (Ruiz Navarro 2015)

Recall that many of the members of the *comparsa* are women but also many are members of the LGBTIQ+ community who have historically been excluded. The freedom enacted by the *comparsa* can not only be seen in the creative development of costumes, which does not censor those that may be seen as too provocative or sexualized, but also in the freedom of expression that is fully perceived when dancing the *champeta* in each of their events. While Colombia is one of the most progressive countries at the level of rights for LGBTIQ+ communities in Latin America and the world (Caribe Afirmativo 2023), the enactment of the 1991 Constitution has been essential for this to occur (Sentiido 2011). Müller (2018) indicates that, thanks to this same Magna Carta, there has been a strengthening of rights for Afro-Colombians and increased visibility of their traditions such as the *champeta*.

Hernández et al. (2013), Mondol et al. (2018), Martínez (2017) and Pardo & Valencia (2011) explore how women have gradually appropriated the culture of *champeta*, which from the beginning was a male-dominated territory. Their texts talk about women's participation and recognition, however, so far none could be found that spoke from intersectionality and that added to the category of women,

others such as class and ethnicity that could be useful for this text (Gómez Gómez 2022). In the same way, in the texts explored there is none that addresses the appropriation of this gender by LGBT communities, which would perhaps mean an interesting look given its cross-cutting perspective between two historically marginalized minorities.

What all texts related to gender issues do mention is that *champeta* is still not a space free of machismo. There are lyrics that denigrate the feminine and their participation is still minimal. This means that even though this means freedom within the *comparsa*, neither women nor LGBTIQ+ communities could feel fully accepted outside of environments such as those offered by *La Puntica No Má'.*

5.3. Third discourse: As a virgin everything is authentic

As a new member or *virgin puntero* it is inevitable to listen to all kinds of music in *La Puntica No Má',* although *cumbia* and *champeta* are undoubtedly the two musical genres that are most perceived. The concerts, the parties, the parades... everything sounds and everything is extraordinary. This feeling of novelty and wonder with each of the sounds that are reproduced in the *comparsa* is undoubtedly one of the most impressive elements. This mainly impacts foreigners and people from other regions of Colombia who have never been to a Carnival before and who see in the *comparsa* a different way of experiencing Carnival. However, my experience as a researcher, one who comes from the city of Barranquilla, made me think that perhaps this feeling also extends to Colombians from the Caribbean and to the Barranquilleros themselves who see in *La Puntica* a *comparsa* that takes risks not only in what has to do with the costumes but also in terms of sound. When reviewing the interviews and the notes on conversations with other virgin *punteros*, local or not, it can be verified that the feeling was shared and that all described it as something magical, that does not have a defined meaning, only admiration, surprise and fascination for the novelty.

While I knew many of the rhythms and songs that were played at the *comparsa* events, the way each individual or the collective relates to each musical sample is different. The meanings and codes that these songs have within the *comparsa* were unknown to me, being a local. Also, it is not the same to know a song like "Qué bonito" by Bomba Estéreo on the radio, as it is to hear it for the first time during a *La Puntica No Má'* event, followed by a drum roll playing *cumbia*s. It was strange to me that in the same *comparsa* two musical genres with such different formats were performed and danced simultaneously as *La Puntica No Má'* does, since the norm in the Carnival of Barranquilla is that its *comparsas* appropriate only one musical genre or several that have similar characteristics such as the format of instrumentation. In this sense, the musical approach of the motto "Tradition in evolution" as understood by *La Puntica No Má'* is an exception.

What is certain is that in order to identify and internalize the discourses that these two musical genres may have within the *comparsa*, a first moment of encounter with them is necessary. This first encounter, which is difficult to describe, but which can be defined as a unique experience about an environment that is just getting to know can indicate what Wesener (2017), Kim, Oh, Lee & Lee (2018) and Yi, Lin, Jin & Luo (2017) call experiential authenticity. This is because the meanings of the stories (narratives) and their performances (representations) that one did not have or previously had about certain elements, of which one even already has some knowledge, collide with an alternate version of them, resulting in something novel and authentic.

This shock is not really related to a specific musical genre, in fact it can be any one that has been listened to, it can be with a *cumbia*, or a *champeta*, or any other musical genre that has had an initial impact, and it is emphasized that it is initial because with time and with the full understanding of the meanings of each sound material this fades away.

5.4. Music as discursive masking in a carnival troupe full of masks

We have seen how the narratives and performances of *La Puntica No Má'* were crucial to identify two musical genres that are associated with two discourses on authenticity, while the latter was identified by a first impression or total ignorance or clash with the meanings of the stories (narratives) and their performances (representations) that the music as a whole might have within the *comparsa*. What is striking here is that these three discourses participate within the same context, which is the *comparsa* of *La Puntica No Má'*, and that all the members must at some point have embodied each of the three discourses, of course always starting with the last discourse described here. The use of the term "incarnate" is also striking due to the nature of the group that is being investigated in this work, a *comparsa* of costumes where there are many costumes and masks that embody characters that appear once they are used by the members of the group.

It is for this reason that this paper proposes the term "musical discursive masks" to describe these discursive positions that are promoted through a type of music, in a context where individuals sometimes embody one of these discursive masks, ignoring the others, with the possibility of abandoning it to adjust to some other and later, if necessary, to take it up again. The characteristics of the "musical discursive masking" are:

1) They participate in the same system and are recognized under different aesthetic and musical parameters.
2) They have discourses, guided by narratives and representations, which have been shaped by a complex process of globalization.

3) within the same system they can dialogue with each other, support each other or, on the contrary, contradict each other.
4) they are temporary, they are interchangeable.
5) all members of the system have embodied them in some way at some time.

In the system of *La Puntica No Má'* there would be three musical discursive masking of authenticity:

- **Virgin masking:** It is related to the experiential discourse on authenticity, in which the first experience of the individual is perceived as an authentic fact. It is mainly experienced by virgin or new *punteros* who are just confronted with certain sonorities whose meanings of this *comparsa* they have not yet internalized.
- **Masking of *cumbia*:** It is related to an essentialist discourse on authenticity linked to the musical genre of *cumbia*. It is based on that approach towards the pure, the unique and the ancestral, whose value lies in highlighting its multiethnic origins and its precursor function, under the premise that the roots articulate the *comparsa* and its sonorities. It conveys a rejection of anything that could erase these values. From the perspective of globalization, it can be said that this discursive masking is sustained by narratives that refer to its first two stages ("formation" and part of the "institutionalization") that are related to the carnival as it is explained as a consequence of a miscegenation typical of the colonial era and of a strong process of classification (folklore studies), protection and safeguarding (heritage studies), and legitimization (institutions) that seek to give meaning to all kinds of reasons for its value. It could also be said that this discourse goes through representations that seek to recall the beginnings of the *comparsa* and its inspiration for the creation of *La Puntica No Má'*.
- **Masking of *champeta*:** It is related to a constructivist discourse on authenticity linked to the musical genre of *champeta*. It is based on that approach towards change, towards the new and the modern. It sees in dynamism its greatest value, considering it as something singular, as well as in the capacity to reinvent itself. It embodies the breaking of social, political, economic and aesthetic structures, the vindication of what makes society uncomfortable and the appropriation of new forms for the creation of innovative proposals. From the perspective of globalization, this discursive masking is supported by the narratives of the last two stages (part of the "institutionalization" and integration) that are related to the carnival, as it questions the way in which the structures of society were cemented (mainly in the narratives within the Academy) and communicates and feeds aesthetically and ideologically from a series of interconnected nodes that lie in various parts of the world, thanks to advances in technology. On the other hand, this discourse could be understood as circulating through representations that explore the future of the *comparsa*, new generations and freedom of expression.

It should be noted that the last two masks present tension, since they contradict each other in what they seek to promote while being in the same *comparsa*. On the one hand, it could be said that the masking of *cumbia* does not align with the masking of *champeta* because its appearance invites to explore the external and the new. On the other hand, the masking of *champeta* might not coincide with the masking of *cumbia* because the latter closes itself to what is already written and seeks to find inspiration in the past. The truth is that when we review the history of each of these two genres we see that the previous ideas are not entirely true. *Cumbia* has had its own evolution and has known how

to relate to new technologies, otherwise Andy Uproot would not be experimenting with *cumbia* de *Chorrera* and creating fusions. *Champeta* still advocates for sounds of the past that have not yet been discovered or that are worth rescuing from the past, that is why Wganda Kenya was presented at the *verbena* party of *La Puntica* in 2023. Which would indicate that these maskings could have been reversed if the way they were constructed had been different.

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6. Conclusions

In this paper we have seen how, through a mixed methodology, it has been possible to verify that for *La Puntica No Má'*, a collective costume troupe of the Carnival of Barranquilla, there are two musical genres that stand out in their narratives and musical representations: *cumbia* and *champeta*. A triangulation analysis of these narratives and representations allowed us to discover which discourses on authenticity were transmitted through these musical genres. The discourses in this context were presented as "musical discursive masking", which are discursive positions on the same topic promoted by certain musical genres and which are characterized because a) they are recognized under different aesthetic and musical parameters within the same system; b) they have discourses, guided by narratives and representations, that have been shaped by a complex process of globalization; c) within the same system they can dialogue with each other, support each other or, on the contrary, contradict each other; d) they are temporary and interchangeable, and e) all members of the group have embodied them in some way at some time.

This research identified three musical discursive maskings: the *cumbia*, the *champeta* and the virgin. Each is associated with each of the three types of discourses on authenticity (essentialist, constructivist

and experiential) described by Salge Ferro (2020). The masking of *cumbia* advocates an essentialist discourse on authenticity that values ancestry as unique and origins as pure. From the perspective of globalization, it has a strong relationship with the first narratives that were told about carnival, i.e. those that talk about the creation of carnival and tried to explain it based on studies of folklore, heritage and institutions. His transit through the representations is perceived in the way in which he presents himself as an asset that seeks to recall the beginnings of the *comparsa* and his inspiration for the creation of *La Puntica No Má'*.

In the masking of *champeta*, the constructivist discourse on authenticity that understands the process as the most precious for its uniqueness shines through. From the perspective of globalization, this discursive masking is supported by narratives of the last two stages (part of the "institutionalization" and integration) of the carnival, as it reviews the way in which the structures of society were molded and the role of technology in it. On the other hand, it could be understood that this discourse circulates through representations that explore the future of the *comparsa*, the new generations and freedom of expression. Finally, there is the virgin masking where the experiential discourse on authenticity highlights the clash between preconceived ideas about certain elements, and their arrangement and meanings within the *comparsa*.

This research shows how these musical discursive maskings can exist within the same comparsa, despite their contradictions. These incongruities coincide with the classical theory of carnival proposed by Bakhtin (Bakhtin 1987; Lachmann 1988-89) in the sense that the existence of a polyphony of voices that distance themselves from reality through the superimposition of dualities that do not function in everyday life ("the grotesque", in Bakhtin's words) is perceived. For this, the differentiation by periods was very key thanks to the use of the globalization approach. In this way, it was possible to have a broader vision of the emergence of certain narratives and representations.

On the other hand, the masking discourses show how the discourses, when divided into imaginaries and investigated, show historical flaws, lack of evidence and generalizations that have been accumulating. We see how the antiquity of the participation of millo in the carnival in the case of cumbia or the innovative character of champeta, which can make use of songs from past decades, can be easily questioned.

The discursive masking in turn allowed us to see how accumulated discourses have continued to shape narratives and representations during carnival. In the midst of a struggle between discourses that understand authenticity as a good to be protected and those that advocate change as the ultimate expression of the authentic, the carnival leaves no evidence that during the days of the festivities the essence of the social, economic and political structures of a city like Barranquilla changes temporarily.

Sometimes the opposite happens, revealing unpopular practices for some, such as cultural appropriation, but it has also promoted new positions such as the recognition of certain identities. In this way creation and reinterpretation are mixed creating new musical proposals for the future exploring those of the past, in a more conscious and critical way in front of the old hegemonic configurations.

As a final reflection, it was asked whether there could be discursive masking in other types of events other than the one presented here. An example could be the concerts and parades organized by the Colombian government to commemorate Colombia's independence every year on July 20. On this day, different sound samples can be played, from pop music to the National Anthem of Colombia, including folk music from each of the regions of Colombia. In this case there may be clashing discourses related to the concept of independence: on the one hand, there will be those who could adjust to the discursive masking of marches and the National Anthem, with postures that advocate independence as a consequence of a legitimate use of force and the imposition of sovereignty, on the other hand, there will be those who adjust to the masking of traditional music, who understand independence as the full development of cultural differences, and there will also be the masking of pop, with followers that understand independence as the feeling of spontaneity and lack of stress. All of the above, of course, are assumptions that require additional research work.

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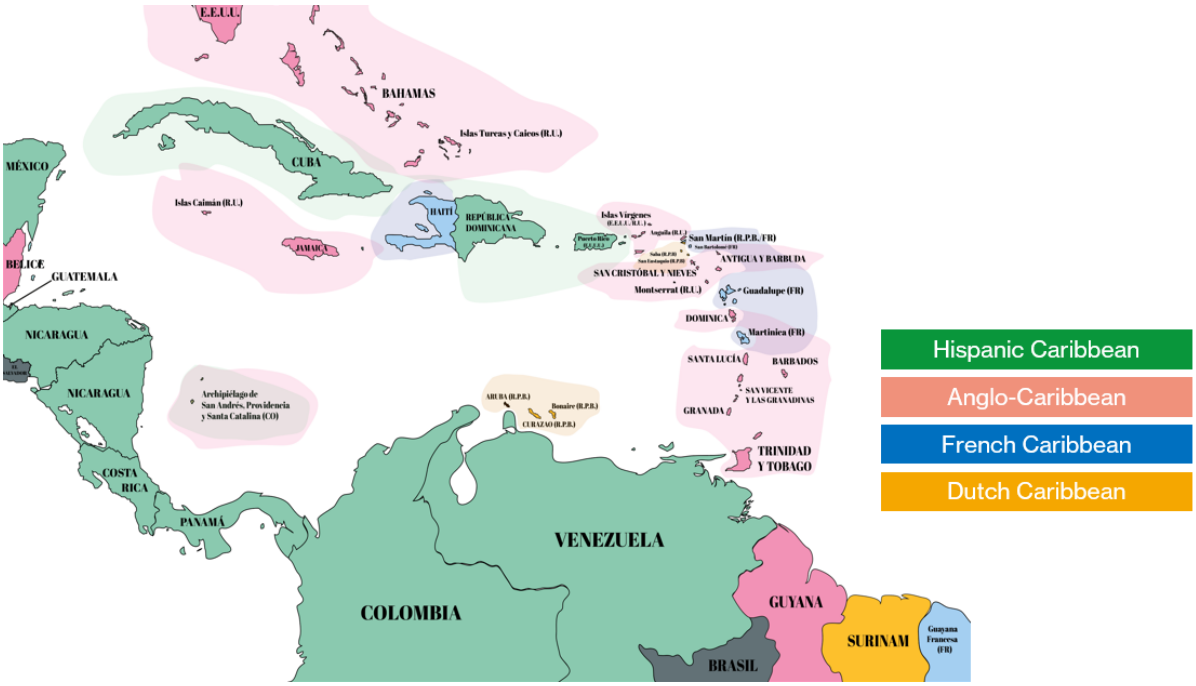
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Appendices

A. Caribbean countries*



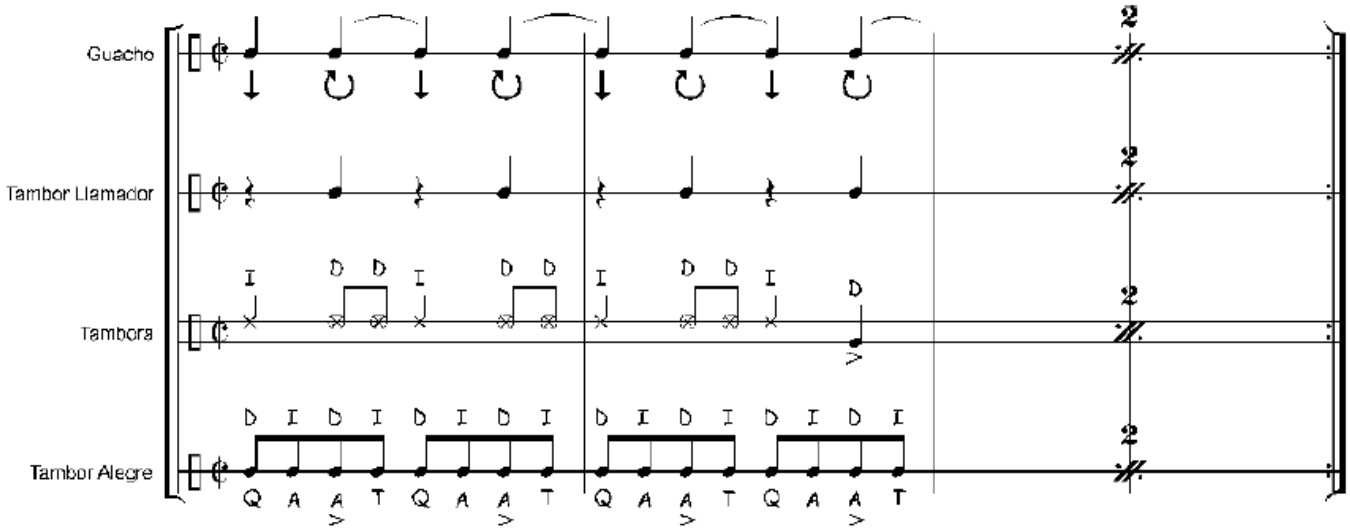
* The countries facing this sea are usually called Caribbean countries, although in some cases only a part of their inhabitants identify themselves as Caribbean, since only a part of their territory is economically, politically, historically and culturally linked to this region, for example, the Colombian Caribbeans, the Floridians in the United States and the yucatecans in Mexico.

B. Location of Barranquilla in the Colombian Caribbean / Americas





C. *Cumbia* rhythm



Source: Valencia Rincón, Victoriano. 2004. *Pitos y tambores: cartilla de iniciación musical* [Whistles and drums: Musical initiation booklet]. Bogotá : Ministerio de Cultura de Colombia.

D. *Conjunto de Grupo de Millo* (*Millo* musical group)



Above, from left to right: a) *Millo*, b) *Guache* or *guacho*, c) Maracas.
Below, from left to right: d) *Llamador*, e) *Alegre*, f) *Tambora*.

Source: Abadía Morales, Guillermo. 1995. El ABC del folclor colombiano [The ABC of Colombian folklore]. Bogotá : Editorial Panamericana.

E. The dimensions of globalización according to Appadurai (1996)

ETHNOSCAPE	The flow of people across boundaries (movement of people around the world). **For example:** refugees, economic migrants, tourist, slave trade, internally displaced people (IDP)
TECHNOSCAPE	The global flows of technology (the ways technologies help speed up cross-border movements). **For example:** handheld devices, internet, smartphones
IDEOSCAPE	The global flow of ideas (ideas, symbols and narratives that have spread around the globe). **For example:** capitalism, socialism, freedom, welfare, rights, sovereignty, representation, democracy
FINANCESCAPE	The flow of money across political borders (rapid movement of money across borders). **For example:** stock exchange, credit cards, new transfer technologies, slave trade,
MEDIASCAPE	The flow of media across borders (power of international media to send news information across the globe at a rapid rate). **For example:** BBC, 24-hours news, blogging, influencers, newspapers, Magazines, television, Films, apps

F. Proposal of the researcher to participate in the 2023 edition with the comparsa of *La Puntica No Má'*



"The tastiest drowned man in the world"

My costume is inspired by (the most important Colombian Caribbean writer) G.G. Márquez's short story "The Most Beautiful Drowned Man in the World", and basically, I will be a drowned fisherman full of radioactive seaweed, with a hat, a fishing net in the shape of a cape with encrusted sea creatures and a big eel (very phallic) wrapped around it. I will have a "mop" with sequins, I will not wear a shirt and I will be made up in shades of blue, green and purple (I am drowned) and I will have a luminous microorganism and mushrooms on me that will form a symbiosis with my skin. Everything will be made of fantasy materials. I will be the dandy of the water, the most gallant drowned man in the parade, laughing his head off and eating every living (or dead) creature that appears to him. I return from the wet darkness to fulfill its deepest desires. I will dance with the sway of the waves: sometimes unleashed and furious, sometimes gallant and elated, but ALWAYS flirtatious. He won't let them touch his slippery eel, the source of his life-giving power, just as Samson's hair smothers him and drives him mad, giving him that delicious, rather Caribbean, powerful energy of the god Eros.

G. “La Quinceañera”, written by Daniel Angulo.

Original text (Spanish)	Translation (English)
Que mañana te pago	That tomorrow I'll pay you
Que ya no bebo más	That I don't drink anymore
La última y nos vamos	The last one and we're leaving
La puntica no más.	The last one no more.
Son las cuatro mentiras	These are the four lies
de todo carnaval	of every carnival
suelta ya la locura	let go of the madness
y vente a La Puntica.	and come to La Puntica.
Oiga vieja Flavia	Hey old Flavia
Es digno de celebrar	It's worth celebrating
Los quince añitos	Fifteen years old
De cipote pela	De cipote pela
Saca ya tu pareja	Take out your partner
Y ponte a bailar	And start dancing
Que toda La Puntica	That all of La Puntica
Ya está bien pela.	It's enough already pela.
Oiga viejo Francis	Hey old Francis
Buena por el disfraz	Good for the costume
Vacílate a la gente	Empty yourself to the people
Ser uno espiritual.	Be a spiritual one.
Lo digo con alegría	I say it with joy
Lo digo con disimulo	I say it with dissimulation
Que el puntero más viejo	That the oldest pointer
Ese es Daniel Angulo.	That's Daniel Angulo.
Que no pudo venir	Who couldn't come
Y siempre está presente	And is always present
Esa es la vieja Ingrid	That's the old Ingrid
Esa es mi presidente	That's my president
Que esta tronco de comparsa	That this amazing comparsa
Está bien crecidita	It is all grown up
Cuando sale a bailar	When its members go out to dance
Todos soban La Puntica	Everybody *soban* La Puntica
Vamos a celebrar	Let's celebrate
A la cipote pela	A la cipote pela
Que está de quinceañera	That she's a quinceañera
Aquí en la Puntica	Here in La Puntica
A la cipote pela	A la cipote pela
Aquí en La Puntica.	Here in La Puntica.

Source: https://soundcloud.com/danielartangulo

H. “Qué Bonito”, by Bomba Estéreo.

Original text (Spanish)	Translation (English)
Original y apretadito	Original and tight
Y aquí suena	And here it sounds
Oye cómo se baila pegado	Listen to how you dance glued
Y ahí estábamos esa noche	And there we were that night
Cuando estábamos bailando	When we were dancing
Y estábamos sudados	And we were sweaty
Mira, como bailo a medio lado	Look, how I dance to the side
Al ritmo de esta champeta	To the rhythm of this champeta
Cuando estábamos conectando	When we were connecting
Y estaba emocionado	And I was excited
Qué bonito es bailar apretado	How nice it is to dance tight
Qué bonito es estar a tu lado	How nice it is to be by your side
Qué bonito es bailar apretado	How nice it is to dance tight
Qué bonito	How nice
Qué bonito es bailar apretado	How nice it is to dance tight
Qué bonito es estar a tu lado	How nice it is to be by your side
Qué bonito es bailar apretado	How nice it is to dance tight
Qué bonito	How nice
Recuerda aquella noche en carnaval en Barranquilla	Remember that night at carnival in Barranquilla
Después la gozadera y bailamos en la puntica	After the gozadera and we danced in the puntica
Recuerda aquella noche en carnaval en Barranquilla	Remember that night at carnival in Barranquilla
Después la gozadera y bailamos en la puntica	After the gozadera and we danced on the pole
Y préndele	And hold on to it
Y agárrale	And grab her
Y cógela	And catch it
Y agárrala y agárrala	And grab it and grab it and grab it
Y préndelo y préndelo	And hold it and hold it and hold it
Y préndelo y préndelo	And hold him and hold him and hold him
Y vuélvete loco y vuélvete loco	And go crazy and go crazy and go crazy
Y vuélvete loco y vuélvete loco	And go crazy and go crazy and go crazy
Qué bonito qué bonito mama	How pretty how pretty mama
Qué bonito qué bonito papa	How pretty how pretty daddy
Qué bonito qué bonito mama	How pretty how pretty mama
Qué bonito qué bonito papa	How nice how nice daddy
Hay qué bonito	How nice it is
Hay oye qué bonito	Hay hey how nice
Hay vamos suavecito	Hay vamos suavecito
Hay vamos despacito	Hay vamos despacito
Qué bonito es bailar apretado	How nice it is to dance tight
Qué bonito es estar a tu lado	How nice it is to be by your side
Qué bonito es bailar apretado	How nice it is to dance tight
Qué bonito	How nice
El olor de tu cuerpo, el sabor de tu piel	The smell of your body, the taste of your skin
Tus besos y tus caricias, cuando yo me desperté	Your kisses and your caresses, when I woke up
El olor de tu cuerpo, el sabor de tu piel	The smell of your body, the taste of your skin
Tus besos y tus caricias, cuando yo me desperté	Your kisses and your caresses, when I woke up
Y en la tienda de la esquina y nos vamos para arriba	And in the corner store and we go upstairs

Authors: Federico Simon Mejia Ochoa / Julian Salazar Martinez / Liliana Margarita Saumet Avila | Lyrics “Qué bonito” © Sony/ATV Music Publishing LLC, Warner Chappell Music, Inc

I. “Carnavalera”, by Bomba Estéreo y Systema Solar.

Original text (Spanish)	Translation (English)
Systema Solar y Bomba Estéreo, vaya	Systema Solar and Bomba Estéreo, go
Que siempre tiene lista la pollera	Who always has his skirt ready
(Carnavalera)	(Carnavalera)
Ella llega, sin falta, a la verbena	She arrives, without fail, to the verbena
(Carnavalera)	(Carnavalera)
En comparsa, siempre con la calle llena	In comparsa, always with a full street
(Carnavalera)	(Carnavalera)
Encumbiada, hey, prende la vela	Encumbiada, hey, light the candle
(Carnavalera)	(Carnavalera)
Yo traigo alegría pa' mi corazón, pa' tu corazón, pa' los corazones	I bring joy for my heart, for your heart, for all hearts
Yo traigo alegría pa' mi corazón, pa' tu corazón, pa' los corazones	I bring joy for my heart, for your heart, for all hearts
(Carnavalera)	(Carnavalera)
Pa' tu corazón	For your heart
Pa' tu corazón	For your heart
Pa' tu corazón	For your heart
Pa' los corazones	For the hearts
(Carnavalera)	(Carnavalera)
Yo traigo alegría pa' mi corazón, pa' tu corazón, pa' los corazones	I bring joy to my heart, to your heart, to all hearts.
Carnavales con los bailes, con la carnavalera	Carnivals with the dances, with the carnavalera
Siempre la gozadera, pásame la Maizena	Always the gozadera, pass me the cornstarch
Que la vaina está buena, ven, llega	That the pod is good, come on, come on, arrive
Po-po-po-ponte pilo en la juega	Po-po-po-po-ponte pilo en la juega
Mira que la vida entera es pa' pasarla plena	Look that the whole life is to spend it to the fullest
Y tú, cómo tienes tu espíritu, tu virtud	And you, how you have your spirit, your virtue
Tu salud, de la luz, qué felicidad que la vida da	Your health, of the light, what happiness life gives you
Si está encendida	If it is lit
Alegría todos los días, que eso va, papá	Joy every day, that it goes, daddy
Se desborde ya, la felicidad, en el carnaval, yo quiero bailar	Happiness is already overflowing, in the carnival, I want to dance
Con la carnavalera	With the carnavalera
Yo traigo alegría pa' mi corazón, pa' tu corazón, pa' los corazones	I bring joy to my heart, to your heart, to all hearts.
(Carnavalera)	(Carnavalera)
Yo traigo alegría pa' mi corazón, pa' tu corazón, pa' los corazones	I bring joy for my heart, for your heart, for all hearts
Pa' tu corazón	For your heart
Pa' tu corazón	For your heart
Pa' tu corazón	For your heart
Pa' los corazones	For the hearts
Yo traigo alegría pa' mi corazón, pa' tu corazón, pa' los corazones	I bring joy to my heart, to your heart, to your hearts, to the hearts
(Carnavalera)	(Carnavalera)
Pa' tu corazón	For your heart
Pa' tu corazón	For your heart
Pa' tu corazón	Pa' your heart
Pa' los corazones	For the hearts
Vamo' a arma' una revolución	Let's start a revolution
Con esta canción y felicidad	With this song and happiness
Con cantos que salen del corazón	With songs that come from the heart
Y con la intención, vamos a bailar	And with the intention, let's dance
Que siempre tiene lista la pollera	That always has the pollera ready
(Carnavalera)	(Carnavalera)

Ella llega, sin falta, a la verbena (Carnavalera) En comparsa, siempre con la calle llena (Carnavalera) De cumbiamba, hey, prende la vela Que siempre tiene lista la pollera (Carnavalera) Ella llega, sin falta, a la verbena (Carnavalera) En comparsa, siempre con la calle llena (Carnavalera) De cumbiamba, hey, prende la vela Yo traigo alegría, alegría, alegría, alegría (Alegría, vaya, hey) Pa' pode' bailar toda la noche y el día (Carnavalera)	She arrives, without fail, to the verbena (Carnavalera) In comparsa, always with the street full (Carnavalera) Of cumbiamba, hey, light the candle She's always got her skirt ready (Carnavalera) She arrives, without fail, to the verbena (Carnavalera) In comparsa, always with the street full (Carnavalera) De cumbiamba, hey, light up the candle I bring joy, joy, joy, joy, joy, joy (Joy, go, hey) Pa' pode' to dance all night and day (Carnavalera)

Athors: Federico Simon Mejia Ochoa / Liliana Margarita Saumet Avila / Andres Gutierrez / Daniel Broderick / Jhon Primera / Juan Carlos Pellegrino / Walter Hernández / Arturo Acosta Corpas / Jose Henrique Castillo Silvera / Pata De Parro / Efrain Antonio Cuadrado Escorcia | Lyrics © Emi Blackwood Music Inc., Sony/atv Latin Music Publishing Llc

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J. Survey



Sección 1 de 2

Survey 1. Music in Carnival (English version)

The following survey is part of a research project of the University of Würzburg in Bavaria (Germany) that seeks to know the impact of social networks on the music that is heard in each edition of the Carnival of Barranquilla. This survey has the permission of the Organization of La Puntica no ma' and should be answered only by active members of the collective. The response you make will remain anonymous and may be only used for scholarly and educational purposes, including publications and exhibitions, with the exception of email information which will not be shared for any reason and will only be used if the researcher needs to contact someone to request more information for this project. **We thank you in advance for your participation.**

I agree to the uses of these materials described above. *

- ○ I agree.
- ○ I don't agree (The information provided will not be taken into account for this research)

1. Age *

Texto de respuesta corta

2. City/Place of residence *

Texto de respuesta corta

2.1. City / place of birth *

Texto de respuesta corta

3. Nationality *

Texto de respuesta corta

4. Gender *

- ○ Female
- ○ Male
- ○ Non-binary
- ○ Otra...

5. Sexual orientation *

- ○ Straight
- ○ Gay/Lesbian
- ○ Bi
- ○ Asexual
- ○ I prefer not to answer.
- ○ Otra...

6. Socioeconomic *estrato* (if living in Colombia) *

- ○ 1
- ○ 2
- ○ 3
- ○ 4
- ○ 5
- ○ 6
- ○ Does not apply

7. Occupation *

Texto de respuesta larga

8. E-mail *

Texto de respuesta larga

9. How many years have you participated as a member of the collective in the activities of La Puntica no ma'? *

- ○ This is my first year (I am a virgin)
- ○ 2 years
- ○ 3 years
- ○ 4 years
- ○ More than 5 years

10. What does music mean to you? *

Texto de respuesta larga

11. What are the five musical genres you most enjoy listening to at home (in order of preference, the first one being the one you like the most)?

Descripción (opcional)

Musical genre at home #1 *

Texto de respuesta corta

Musical genre at home #2 *

Texto de respuesta corta

Musical genre at home #3 *

Texto de respuesta corta

Musical genre at home #4 *

Texto de respuesta corta

Musical genre at home #5 *

Texto de respuesta corta

Sección 2 de 2

About carnival music...

Descripción (opcional)

12. Describe carnival music in 5 words/terms

Descripción (opcional)

1. *

Texto de respuesta corta

2. *

Texto de respuesta corta

3. *

Texto de respuesta corta

4. *

Texto de respuesta corta

14. What music genres do you expect to hear at the carnival (in order of preference, the first one being the one you like the most)?

Descripción (opcional)

Musical genre (in Carnival) #1 *

Texto de respuesta corta

Musical genre (in Carnival) #2 *

Texto de respuesta corta

Musical genre (in Carnival) #3

Texto de respuesta corta

Musical genre (in Carnival) #4

Texto de respuesta corta

5. *

Texto de respuesta corta

13. What do you like most about carnival music? *

- [ ] It's fun.
- [ ] It gets me dancing.
- [ ] It represents my culture.
- [ ] People associate me with this music.
- [ ] I find it interesting.
- [ ] It puts me in a good mood.
- [ ] Otra...

Musical genre (in Carnival) #5

If you want to write more than five genres write them all here.

Texto de respuesta corta

15. With which of these carnival music formats do you feel most identified? Choose two. *

A musical format is a type of musical ensemble, for example choir, symphony orchestra, etc.

- [ ] Tropical group (piano, congas, güiro, guitar, trumpets, tromboune, saxophone, clarinets, bass, drums... lik...
- [ ] Picó (electronic sounds, folk-electronic fusion, sometimes with electroacustic instruments, etc.)
- [ ] Parranda vallenata (Acordeon, caja vallenata, guacharaca, bass)
- [ ] Papayera (Trumpets, clarinets, tromboune, saxophone, drums, cymbals)
- [ ] Millo or gaitas group (traditional drums, maracas, traditional flutes like millo and gaitas)

16. How do you discover new carnival music? *

- [ ] In the Carnival parades
- [ ] At the Carnival parties, such as the "verbenas"
- [ ] On the Radio
- [ ] Family
- [ ] Friends
- [ ] At School
- [ ] On internet (not social networks)
- [ ] On Whatsapp
- [ ] On Spotify
- [ ] On Deezer
- [ ] On YouTube
- [ ] On Instagram
- [ ] On Facebook
- [ ] On SoundCloud
- [ ] On TikTok
- [ ] Otra...

17. Make a list of up to 10 songs that you remember and would recommend to enjoy the carnival.

Please write the name of the song and the artist.

Song # 1 *

Please write the name of the song and the artist.

Texto de respuesta corta

Song # 2

Please write the name of the song and the artist.

Song # 3

Please write the name of the song and the artist.

Texto de respuesta corta

Song # 4

Please write the name of the song and the artist.

Texto de respuesta corta

Song # 5

Please write the name of the song and the artist.

Texto de respuesta corta

Song # 6

Please write the name of the song and the artist.

Texto de respuesta corta

Song # 7

Please write the name of the song and the artist.

Texto de respuesta corta

Song # 8

Please write the name of the song and the artist.

Texto de respuesta corta

Song # 9

Please write the name of the song and the artist.

Texto de respuesta corta

Song # 10

Please write the name of the song and the artist.

Texto de respuesta corta

18. If you have any, share the link(s) to a personal playlist(s) (from Spotify, Youtube, SoundCloud or other social networks) with carnival music that you like.

Texto de respuesta larga

The survey ends here.

Thank you very much for participating!

K. Additional information of the shared data via Whatsapp (La Puntica Group)

(1)

#	Date	Music genre [count]	Link
A1	11.01.2023	Champeta [16]	https://open.spotify.com/track/7wG0dUc0SHwIq4PSlHDLrr?si=rgeb70d8RCqgbI7K_0wqLA
A2	11.01.2023	Champeta [1]	https://www.instagram.com/reel/CnSnW_BB0Ve/?igshid=MWI4MTIyMDE%3D
A3	13.01.2023	Tropical music/champeta [1]	https://youtu.be/-k_FL1bGNLI
A4	16.01.2023	African music [13] Salsa [7] Vallenato [2] Tropical music [3] Afro-Caribbean in English [6] Champeta [3] Traditional ensemble music [2] Latin Afro-Caribbean [3] Other [2] = 41 songs in total	https://open.spotify.com/playlist/6JnfYKxgUSuncpnTHe3NC1?si=3NIBwzmwTZysqLrrx5gX9w
A5	16.01.2023	African music [1]	https://youtu.be/mUunvB0mg1I
A6	17.01.2023	Champeta [17]	https://palenquerecords.bandcamp.com/album/dj-rata-piano-ca-onazos-picoteros
A7	17.01.2023	African Music [2] Latin Afro-Caribbean [5] = 9 songs in total	https://open.spotify.com/track/4DR5hTV4gk4z3PWWeotTJz?si=GywIz4ugSdmnQ5yPuUKS2A
A8	17.01.2023	Latin Afro-Caribbean [1]	https://youtu.be/bTAkOs5KsJU
A9	17.01.2023	Salsa [9] Tropical music [9] Latin Afro-Caribbean [4] = 22 songs in total	https://open.spotify.com/track/3Pa4jkz9HuA6a04dM8zOAK?si=IpBbbWHoRtmJjMS368giaA
A10	17.01.2023	Champeta [39] African music [59] Latin Afro-Caribbean [14] Salsa [44] Tropical music [2] Vallenato (2) Fusion [7] Other [27] = 192 songs in total	https://open.spotify.com/playlist/5sNSidIVZLio3Q8PaWHSrX?si=luqZSEutQYeq_mOKmJN5RA

(2)

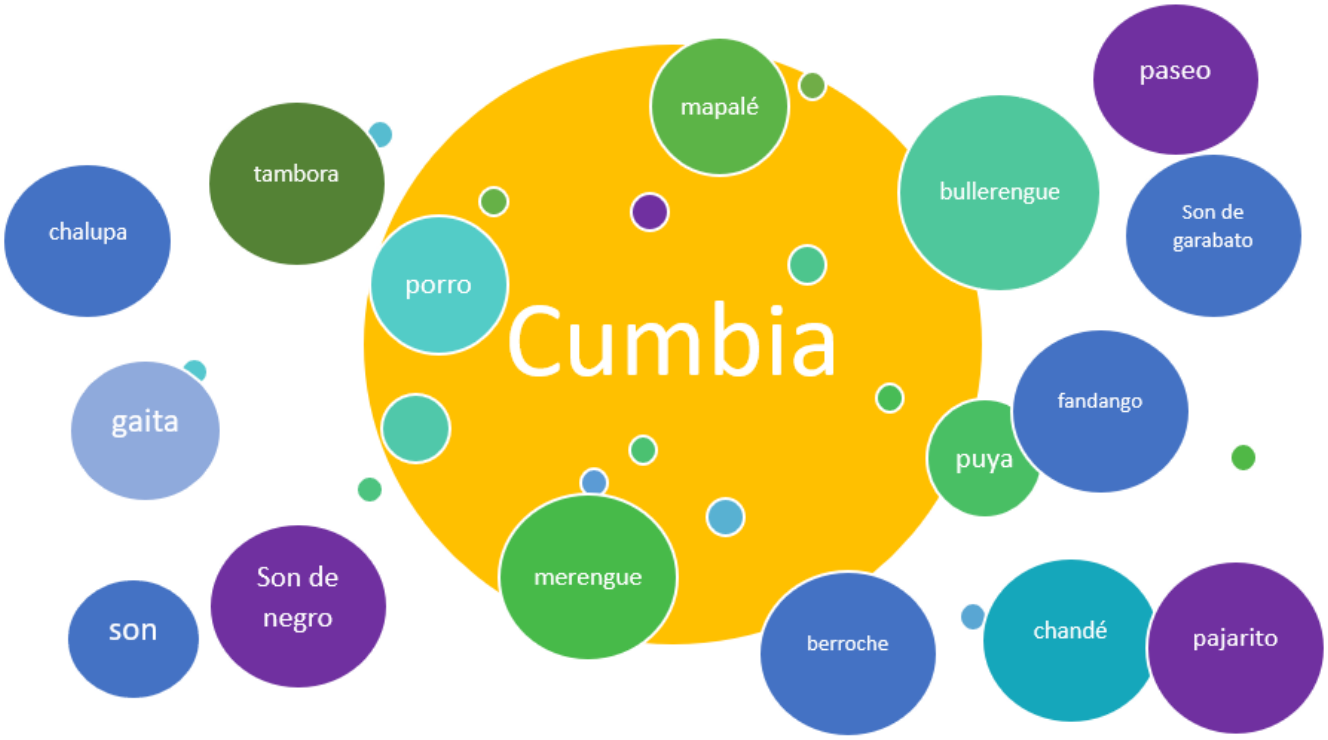
#	Date	Tipo de música [conteo]	Link

B1	08.04.2023	Latin Afro-Caribbean	https://open.spotify.com/track/4tdXOga7onrggE8nM20GFk?si=TDsHmeL9ToKxFKHyV5O6nw&context=spotify%3Aplaylist%3A37i9dQZF1DZ06evO3Ow1KE
B2	08.04.2023	Rock-pop	https://open.spotify.com/track/1PQzZbitOJ6XPFg7FFzsKQ?si=xU4YUYe6RMaSh-bZJ7bmQw
B3	14.04.2023	Latin Afro-Caribbean	https://youtu.be/mSmEZm7x9GM?si=SAT2_yWNN73MvOWX
B4	14.04.2023	African music	https://open.spotify.com/track/3MT4pzIWi2UrRkVDe03S5t?si=6RW7MVy-RUGjYqDgbX7cew&dd=1
B5	17.04.2023	Tropical	https://youtu.be/rTmTqOXzQHA?si=iI7lpBEhIDd7LOAW
B6	24.04.2023	Vallenato	https://www.instagram.com/reel/CrRLWxZLQhX/?igshid=YmMyMTA2M2Y%3D
B7	27.04.2023	Champeta	https://youtu.be/S-07QR_KnLE?si=nOkJDWpjqZjdy38F
B8	14.05.2023	Salsa	https://youtu.be/_5ZRpbxlu5g?si=DB3CjKddndbPEIis
B9	24.05.2023	Latin Afro-Caribbean	https://youtu.be/Y6qR0vnY9D0?si=gioO-iVrUMhbsH3e
B10	25.06.2023	Electronic music	https://soundcloud.com/kira-ziborova/kira-dj-sunset-11-junio/s-xO66QO0LXVe?ref=whatsapp-image&p=a&c=1&si=44a2d84181a945fda7d30f8ba00195db&utm_source=whatsapp&utm_medium=message&utm_campaign=social_sharing

L. Linear evolution of cumbia, according to Juan Sebastián Ochoa (2019).



M. *Cumbia* as a mother genre, according to Juan Sebastián Ochoa (2019).



N. *Europe, supported by Africa and America* (1796) William Blake



O. Carnival songs (2007-2021)

Year	Title	Interpreter	Country	Genre
2007	*Borracha*	Pipe Peláez	Colombia	Vallenato
2008	*Ta' buena*	Tulile	Dominican Republic	Merengue
2009	*El Ñato mama ron*	Noel Petro	Colombia	Terapia
2010	*El Celular*	Temible Zaa & El Yao	Colombia	Champeta
2011	*El burro intelectual*	Juan Samuel	Colombia	Merengue
2012	*Ai se eu te pego*	Michel Teló	Brazil	MPB
2013	*La Llave [1965]*	Cortijo y su combo	Puerto Rico	Salsa
2014	*El Serrucho*	Mr. Black	Colombia	Champeta
2015	*La Espelucá'*	Twister y Mr. Steve	Colombia	Champeta
2016	*Materialista*	Silvestre Dangond y Nicky Jam	Colombia	Vallenato
2017	*Mpemba*	Hugo Soares	Angola	Kuduro
2018	*Ay, mami ya pa qué*	Rey Three Latino	Colombia	Champeta
2019	*Volvió Juanita [1984]*	Milly Quezada	Dominican Republic	Merengue
2020	*Icha [1995]*	Syran Mbenza	Democratic Republic of the Congo	Soukous
2021	*Te Olvidé [1953]*	Carlos Vives, Maía, Adriana Lucía, et al.	Colombia	Chandé

https://es.wikipedia.org/wiki/Carnaval_de_Barranquilla

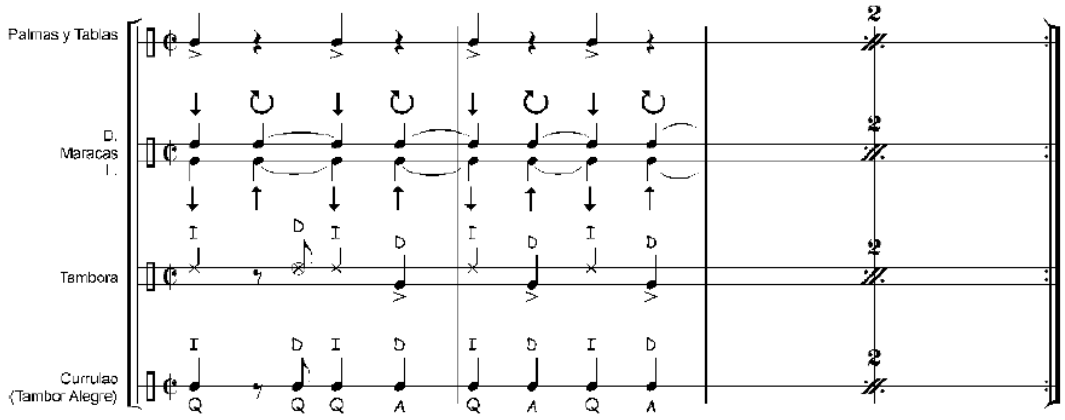
P. Canciones de la Reina del Carnaval

Year	Carnival Queen	Title	Interpreter	Fragment of champeta?
2010	Giselle Lacouture	*Llegó La Reina*	Giselle Lacouture	No
2013	**Daniela Cepeda Tarud**	*Reina Del Carnaval*	Nicolás Tovar	No
2014	**María Margarita *Maqui* Diazgranados Gerlein**	*Maqui Carnaval*	Gustavo Santander	No
2015	**Cristina Felfle Fernández de Castro**	*Muévete y Pégate*	Damian y Chober	No
2016	**Marcela García Caballero**	*Una Sola Gozadera*	Manuel Ariza, Lisandro Polo y Twister El Rey	Yes
2017	**Stephanie *Fefi* Mendoza Vargas**	*Vacilatela Con Fefi*	Bazurto All Stars	Yes
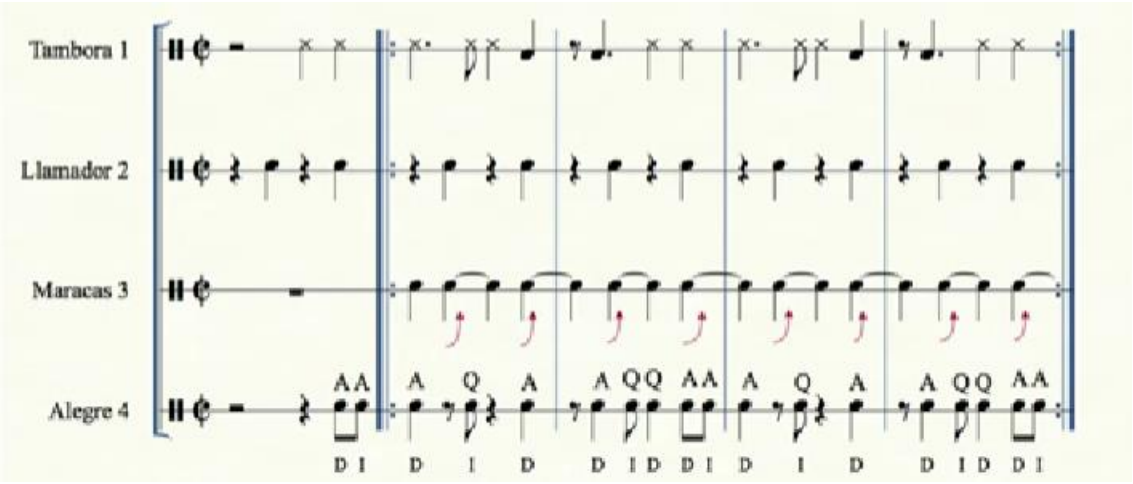
2018	**Valeria Abuchaibe Rosales**	*100tete Más Barranquillero*	Martina La Peligrosa, Twister El Rey, Fausto Chatella y Mauricio Bernal	Yes
2019	**Carolina Segebre Abudinén**	*¡Pura Alegria!*	Eddy Herrera, Checo Acosta, Mr Black y Chelito De Castro	Yes
2020	**Isabella Chams Vega**	*Pa Que Lo Viva La Gente*	Adriana Lucía, Fausto Chatella, Bazurto All Stars, Caliope y Karen Lizarazo	Yes
2022	**Valeria Charris Salcedo**	*La Marimonda*	Tato Marenco, Dolcey Gutiérrez y Rey Three Latino	Yes
2023	**Natalia Maria De Castro González**	*Bailalo Como Es*	Donny Caballero, Mr Black y Fausto Chatella	Yes

Q. Rhythm of *chandé* and *son de garabato*

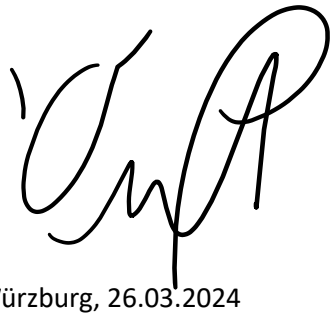
Chandé, according to Valencia (2004)



Son de garabato, according to Burgos (2019)



Erklärung Hiermit versichere ich, dass ich die vorliegende Arbeit selbstständig verfasst, keine anderen als die angegebenen Quellen und Hilfsmittel benutzt und die Arbeit bisher oder gleichzeitig keiner anderen Prüfungsbehörde vorgelegt habe.



Würzburg, 26.03.2024